11

East and West:
The Interaction of New Worlds

1350----------1400----------1450----------1500----------1550----------1600----------1650

1352	Muslim explorer Ibn Battuta travels in West Africa
1368-1644	Ming Dynasty in China
1492	Columbus' first voyage to the New World
1498	Vasco da Gama trades on Malabar coast of India
1517	Martin Luther posts Ninety-five Theses
1519-1521	Hernando Cortés defeats Aztec forces in Mexico
1520-1566	Rule of Ottoman Caliph Süleyman the Lawgiver
1531-1533	Francisco Pizarro conquers Incas of Peru
1543	Portuguese arrive in Japan
1556-1605	Reign of Akbar the Great in India
1585	Spanish extract silver from mines of Potosi
1603	Establishment of Tokugawa Shogunate in Japan
1607	English settlement at Jamestown
1620	Pilgrims land at Plymouth
1630	Puritans found Massachusetts Bay Colony

They are poor discoverers who think that there is no land when they see nothing but sea.
—Sir Francis Bacon

The destiny of nations depends on how they nourish themselves.
–Jean Anthelme Brillat-Savarin

It should be noted that when he seizes a state, the new ruler ought to determine the injuries that he will need to inflict. He should then inflict them all at once, and not have to renew them everyday.
—Niccolò Machiavelli

The use of force is but temporary. It may subdue for a moment; but it does not remove the necessity of subduing again—and a nation is not governed, which is perpetually to be conquered.
—Edmund Burke

I teach kings the history of their ancestors so that the lives of the ancients might serve them as an example, for the world is old, but the future springs from the past.
—The Griot, Mamoudou Kouyaté

CHAPTER THEMES

- ***Systems of Government:*** How did political and economic rivalry among world powers provide motives for exploration and conquest? How did the centralization of monarchies during the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries contribute to the acquisition and maintenance of empire?
- ***Imperialism:*** Why did Europeans explore, conquer, and settle lands in the new worlds of America, Africa, and Asia? Why were they particularly successful in suppressing natives? How important is technology as a factor in progress and destruction? What were the motives behind Chinese or Muslim exploration? Is imperialism a process that inherently carries the seeds of genocide? What are those components?
- ***Propaganda:*** How did Europeans justify their exploitation of the Americas? In order to justify conquest or genocide, must the conquered be methodically dehumanized? How has this process been repeated throughout history and in other world societies?

- ***Church/State Relationships:*** What role did the Catholic Church and Protestant religious exiles play in world exploration and in the settlement of the Americas? Are missionary motives simply another justification for conquest? Or did religious representatives work for accommodation and coexistence? How did the Chinese and Japanese react to Western missionaries? Were they a positive force in the settlement of the Americas? Was religion the primary motive in the creation of the great Islamic empires of the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries?
- ***Historical Change and Transition:*** What impact did the European exploration and conquest of the Americas have on the cultures of both regions? What are some of the "seeds of change" that ultimately linked these continents? Is the interaction between cultures both a beneficial and dangerous process? How and why did the Japanese isolate themselves from outside influences? In our modern world, can a culture be truly homogeneous? What are the challenges of cultural integration and diversity?
- ***The Big Picture:*** Must exploration always result in exploitation? How have world civilizations been changed through "first contact" over the last seven hundred years?

"Discovery! To know that you are walking where no others have walked; that you are beholding what the human eye has not seen before; to give birth to an idea, to discover a great thought. To be the first—that is the idea!" The wit and insight of Mark Twain have often been invoked to reflect on the motivations of the human heart and the condition of human societies. Twain, in his experience as an adventurer and observer of people, did not shield us from the glory and foibles of human endeavor. Perhaps central to our human nature is the need to know, our curiosity that motivates discovery and interaction, that equates the encounter with new and different peoples, customs, and traditions, with the fulfillment of the progressive spirit of adventure. But perhaps this is only the first phase of a process that also opens the door to the darker dimensions of the human soul and unleashes the destructive passions of greed, lust for conquest, and cultural domination.

The history of human beings records a great conflict of opposites as societies struggle for political, social, and economic balance. Stability affords security and strength that often results in risk—exploration, trade, and then exploitation, destruction and a new resolution. Balance to imbalance to balance. The Chinese vision of yin and yang, of the necessity and interaction of opposites, defines the catalyst called curiosity.

In this chapter we will explore the interactions of Western and Eastern societies. The cultures of Europe, America, Asia, and Africa all existed by about the thirteenth century in "old worlds" with more or less established societies, religions, and political organizations. Of course, there had been military, economic, and cultural contact between these regions for centuries as evidenced by the Phoenician circumnavigation of Africa, Chinese trade with the Roman Empire, the Mongol conquests, and the images of Eastern Buddhist statuary that bear a striking resemblance to Alexander the Great. But a more concerted effort to explore the horizons of the world began in the

eleventh century with the voyages of the Vikings to North America and especially with the travels of the Venetian trader Marco Polo to the court of the Mongol chieftain Kublai Khan about 1275. Polo's *A Description of the World* was translated into most European languages and opened a new vision of wealth and culture to the West that excited an interest in geography. Christopher Columbus set sail in 1492 to find the wealth of Chipangu, Polo's name for an outer island of Japan.

One of the most famous world travelers was Ibn Battuta, a Muslim native of Tangier in northern Africa. His long years of exploration down the coasts of Africa and into India and China in the early fourteenth century provide one of the great compendiums of cultural observation and interaction.

These voyages of discovery were certainly not limited to westerners. In fact, some of the most significant indicators of the strength of the Ming dynasty in China were the maritime expeditions commanded by the eunuch, Zheng He, between 1405 and 1433. Navigating by compass along sea routes established by Arab traders, Zheng He led hundreds of ships to Southeast Asia, India, the Arabian Gulf, and East Africa. He set out to demonstrate the glory of the Ming dynasty and to enroll other kingdoms in a tribute system. These voyages were successful in presenting the Chinese court with exotic animals, hostile kings, and some tributary states, but they were short-lived since they were expensive and came at a time when the dynasty needed to focus its resources toward building programs and defensive arrangements. It is interesting to note that although the Chinese possessed the technical knowledge for such expeditions, they lacked the decisive combination of greed, faith, and curiosity that gave rise to the Portuguese trading empire fifty years later.

Exploration was only a means to an end for the Portuguese and Spanish who were motivated by the lure of wealth, the spice trade in India, the gold and silver in the Americas, the slaves of

Africa. After Hernando Cortés and Francisco Pizarro conquered respectively the Aztecs in 1519 and the Incas in 1531, the door lay open for the European domination of a continent. Spanish conquistadores, French trappers, Dutch traders, and English religious refugees all sought to establish themselves on territory that was already occupied by indigenous peoples. Europeans ravaged their land, mocked their gods, banished their languages, decimated their populations through disease, and subjugated their children to a subservient and dependent status that is still in evidence today.

This dominance was certainly disproportionate to the geographic size or population of Europe. Although European apologists would concoct theories that explained and justified the domination of "inferior races," their conquest was not the result of racial superiority, but of technological supremacy. Gunpowder and naval power proved to be the decisive forces in the eradication of Native American cultures.

This interactive relationship between the European and American worlds can be attested by the exchange of crops and animals, but perhaps might best be noted in the specter of disease. Although there is continuing controversy about what diseases were introduced by outsiders into the Americas, it is generally held that smallpox, cholera, measles, diphtheria, typhoid fever, some strains of influenza, and the bubonic plague originated in Asia, Europe, or Africa. The affect of these diseases on American populations without previous exposure or immunity was devastating. Native populations may have declined by seventy-five percent.

The influx of spices into Europe from the Malabar coasts of India and the precious metals delivered by the Spanish treasure fleets from the Americas proved to be a mixed blessing for the economy of Europe and highlights the importance of interdisciplinary study. The increase in gold and silver bullion certainly paid for innovations in printing, shipping, mining, textile manufacturing

and weapons development. The influx of bullion alone allowed Spain to launch the Spanish Armada against England in 1588, France to develop its silk industry, and all of Europe to gorge on the bloody seventeenth century wars of religion. But it also contributed to serious inflation that saw prices doubling in Spain by 1600, and the cost of food and clothing increasing by one hundred percent in Germany by 1540.

Such complex societal change may help explain the fateful decision made by the Japanese to retreat from this exchange of "new worlds." Having just survived a long period of civil strife, the Tokugawa Shogunate isolated Japan by restricting the influence of Western religion and trade. From about 1635 to 1865, Japan maintained political unity and a homogeneous domestic culture in isolation. This flight from curiosity was to be decisive in the history of the world.

This chapter offers us an opportunity to analyze some of the benefits and attendant atrocities of cultural interaction. History is a reflection of the complexity of human environments and as such is necessarily interactive. This is a story of greed, destruction, and ultimately of cultural awareness that affords perspective and presents new possibilities for the progress of world civilization.

Exploration and Exploitation

The adventures and achievements of Christopher Columbus have stirred controversy among historians for over a century. The 1992 quincentenary recognition of his four voyages to the New World reignited debate between those who regard him as a great explorer and true embodiment of the Renaissance spirit of discovery and others who regard him as an exploiter, leader of the first invasion of European barbarians, which resulted in the sixteenth-century conquests of the Aztecs under Hernando Cortés and the Incas at the hands of Francisco Pizarro. Columbus remains an enigmatic figure. His reputation as a skilled navigator has been challenged, and his handling of his men was inept at best. Still, he provides an important example of an individual who, through a supreme confidence in his abilities and in the rightness of his vision, altered the course of history. But just what was his vision, and how positive were his contributions to history?

Columbus expected that since the world was round, he could sail west and arrive at Chipangu, the Japan mentioned by Marco Polo. There the wealth of the East would justify his risk and hardship. Columbus' principal illusion, that he had successfully made the voyage to Asia, was fostered by his need to provide evidence of a wealth that would in turn justify the backing for future exploration. But the islands in the Caribbean that he "discovered" were not rich. The gold he claimed to be just about ready to discover was always on the next island. Ultimately, he was arrested in Santo Domingo for misgovernment and sent home in chains. Yet even this turned to his advantage as Columbus was viewed, even by his enemies, as a man of destiny who had vastly extended the domain of Christianity.

The first selection from Columbus' initial voyage in 1492 is a digest of his lost logbook made by Bartolomé dé Las Casas, a friend of the Columbus family. The second source is a letter written by Columbus to various supporters in Spain on his return journey from the New World. These documents justify his actions but also provide insight into this controversial historical figure.

Christopher Columbus: "Admiral of the Ocean Sea" (1492)

BARTOLOMÉ DE LAS CASAS

On 2 January in the year 1492, when your Highnesses had concluded their war with the Moors [Muslims in Spain] who reigned in Europe, I saw your Highnesses' banners victoriously raised on the towers of the Alhambra, the citadel of that city, and the Moorish king come out of the city gates and kiss the hands of your Highnesses and the prince, My Lord. And later in that same month, on the grounds of information I had given your royal Highnesses concerning the lands of India and a prince who is called the Great Khan—which means in Spanish "King of Kings"—and of his and his

ancestors' frequent and vain application to Rome for men learned in the holy faith who should instruct them in it, your Highnesses decided to send me, Christopher Columbus, to see these parts of India and the princes and peoples of those lands and consider the best means for their conversion. For, by the neglect of the Popes to send instructors, many nations had fallen to idolatry and adopted doctrines of perdition, and your Highnesses as Catholic princes and devoted propagators of the holy Christian faith have always been enemies of the sect of Mahomet [Muhammad] and of all idolatries and heresies.

Your Highnesses ordained that I should not go eastward by land in the usual manner but by the western way which no one about whom we have positive information has ever followed. Therefore having expelled all the Jews from your dominions in that same month of January, your Highnesses commanded me to go with an adequate fleet to those parts of India. In return you granted me great favors bestowing on me the titles of Don and High Admiral of the Ocean Sea and Viceroy and perpetual governor of such islands and mainland as I should discover and win or should in future be discovered and won in the Ocean Sea, and that these rights should be inherited by my eldest son and so on from generation to generation.

I departed from the city of Granada on Saturday, 12 May, and went to the seaport of Palos, where I prepared three ships very suitable for such a voyage and set out from that port well supplied both with provisions and seamen. Half an hour before sunrise on Friday, 3 August, I departed on a course for the Canary Islands, from which possession of your Highnesses I intended to set out and sail until I reached the Indies, there to deliver your Highnesses' letters to their princes and to fulfil your other commands....

TUESDAY, 18 SEPTEMBER

During that day and night they made more than fifty-five leagues but he reckoned only forty-eight. On these days the sea was as smooth as the river at Seville. That day Martin Alonso called ahead in the Pinta, which was a fast ship; because, as he called to the Admiral from his ship, he had seen a great flock of birds flying westward and hoped to sight land that night; this was his reason for not holding back. To the north there appeared a great bank of clouds, which is a sign that land is near.

. . .

WEDNESDAY, 10 OCTOBER

He sailed west-south-west, making ten miles an hour but sometimes dropping to seven and sometimes rising to twelve, and in the day and night together they went fifty-nine leagues, which he counted as no more than forty-four for the men. Here the men could bear no more; they complained of the length of the voyage. But the Admiral encouraged them as best he could, holding out high hopes of the gains they could make. He added that it was no use their complaining, because he had reached the Indies and must sail on until with the help of Our Lord he discovered land.

THURSDAY, 11 OCTOBER

He sailed west-south-west. They ran into rougher seas than any they had met with on the voyage. They saw petrels and a green reed near the ship. The men of the Pinta saw a cane and a stick and picked up another small stick, apparently shaped with an iron tool; also a piece of cane and some land-grasses and a small board. Those on the caravel Nina saw other indications of land and a stick covered with barnacles. At these signs, all breathed again and were rejoiced. That day they went twenty-seven leagues before sunset and after sunset he resumed his original western course. They made twelve miles an hour and up to two hours before midnight had gone ninety miles, which are

twenty-two leagues and a half. The caravel Pinta, being swifter and sailing ahead of the Admiral, now sighted land and gave the signals which the Admiral had commanded.

The first man to sight land was a sailor call Rodrigo from Triana, who afterwards vainly claimed the reward, which was pocketed by Columbus. The Admiral, however, when on the sterncastle at ten o'clock in the night, had seen a light, though it was so indistinct he would not affirm that it was land. He called Pero Gutierrez, butler of the King's table, and told him that there seemed to be a light and asked him to look. He did so and saw it. He said the same to Rodrigo Sanchez of Segovia, whom the King and Queen had sent in the fleet as accountant, and he saw nothing because he was not in a position from which anything could be seen. After the Admiral spoke, this light was seen once or twice and it was like a wax candle that went up and down. Very few thought that this was a sign of land, but the Admiral was quite certain that they were near land. Accordingly, after the recitation of the Salve in the usual manner by the assembled sailors, the Admiral most seriously urged them to keep a good lookout from the forecastle and to watch carefully for land. He promised to give a silk doublet to the first sailor who should report it. And he would be entitled also to the reward promised by the sovereigns, which was an annual payment of ten thousand maravedis [a small copper coin].

Two hours after midnight land appeared, some two leagues away. They took in all sail, leaving only the mainsail, which is the great sail without bonnets, and lay close-hauled waiting for day. This was Friday, on which they reached a small island of the Lucayos, called in the Indian language Guanahani [Watling Island in the Bahamas]. Immediately some naked people appeared and the Admiral went ashore in the armed boat, as did Martin Alonso Pinzon and Vincente Yanez his brother, captain of the Nina. The Admiral raised the royal standard and the captains carried two

banners with the green cross which were flown by the Admiral on all his ships. On each side of the cross was a crown surmounting the letters F and Y (for Ferdinand and Isabella [Ysabela]). On landing they saw very green trees and much water and fruit of various kinds.

The "New World"

CHRISTOPHER COLUMBUS

All these islands are very beautiful, and distinguished by a diversity of scenery; they are filled with a great variety of trees of immense height, and which I believe to retain their foliage in all seasons. . . . The inhabitants of both sexes in this island, and in all the others which I have seen, or of which I have received information, go always naked as they were born, with the exception of some of the women, who use the covering of a leaf or small bough, or an apron of cotton which they prepare for that purpose. None of them . . . are possessed of any iron, neither have they weapons, . . . [for] they are timid and full of fear. They carry however in lieu of arms canes dried in the sun, on the ends of which they fix heads of dried wood sharpened to a point, and even these they dare not use habitually. . . . As soon as they see that they are safe, and have laid aside all fear, they are very simple and honest and exceedingly liberal with all they have. . . . They exhibit great love towards all others in preference to themselves; they also give objects of great value for trifles, and content themselves with very little or nothing in return. I however forbade that these trifles and articles of no value (such as pieces of dishes, plates, and glass, keys, and leather straps) should be given to them, although if they could obtain them, they imagined themselves to be possessed of the most beautiful trinkets in the world. . . . Thus they bartered, like idiots, cotton and gold for fragments of bows, glasses, bottles, and jars; which I forbade as being unjust, and myself gave them many beautiful and acceptable

articles which I had brought with me, taking nothing in return. I did this in order that I might the more easily conciliate them, that they might be led to become Christians, and be inclined to entertain a regard for the King and Queen, our Princes and all Spaniards, and that I might induce them to take an interest in seeking out, and collecting, and delivering to us such things as they possessed in abundance, bu which we greatly needed. They practice no kind of idolatry, but have a firm belief that all strength and power, and indeed all good things would come to them after they had thrown aside their fears. Nor are they slow or stupid, but of very clear understanding; and those men who have crossed to the neighboring islands give an admirable description of everything they observed; but they never saw any people clothed, nor any ships like ours. On my arrival at that sea, I had taken some Indians by force from the first island that I came to, in order that they might learn our language, and communicate to us what they knew respecting the country; this plan succeeded excellently, and was a great advantage to us, for in a short time, either by gestures and signs, or by words, we were enabled to understand each other. These men are still travelling with me, and although they have been with us now a long time, they continue to entertain the idea that I have descended from heaven; and on our arrival at any new place they published this, crying out immediately with a loud voice to the other Indians, "Come, come and look upon beings of a celestial race": upon which both women and men, children and adults, young men and old, when they got rid of the fear they at first entertained, would come out in throngs, crowding the roads to see us.

Consider This:

1) In the logbook of Columbus' first voyage to the New World, what are the primary reasons he gives for wanting to sail to "the lands of India"? Do you think he was revealing the truth? What other motives might have influenced his decision to sail? Can you find evidence of them in this source? How did Columbus treat the inhabitants of the islands? Was Columbus

a great explorer who reflected the adventurous spirit of the Renaissance or an exploiter of peoples?

"Cities of Gold": The European Domination of America

Hernando Cortés and the Conquest of Mexico

A primary area of historical controversy and dissension in the twenty-first century concerns the Spanish conquest of Mexico and Peru and the subsequent administration of Spanish domains in the Western Hemisphere collectively called "New Spain." The role of the Spanish explorers and conquistadors as agents of destruction or purveyors of progress has been hotly disputed in recent years. Subsidized by Spanish royalty, explorers such as Hernando Cortés and Francisco Pizarro landed in Mexico (1519) and Peru (1531), respectively, with lofty dreams and visions of enormous wealth to be extracted from the inhabitants of this mythic land. The Spanish monarchy itself sought the wealth and geopolitical advantage that such a presence in the New World could bring, while the church saw an opportunity to spread the Christian faith to new lands without the stifling competition and dissension that the Protestant Reformation had engendered in Europe.

But it is dangerous to narrow the perspective, and the Spanish presence in New Spain surely combined national interest, religious zealotry, and personal greed. This was an encounter of unparalleled importance, and in the process of consolidating their claims, the Spanish destruction of native peoples and their cultures reflected a European arrogance and confirmation of the Machiavellian principle that the "ends justify the means." Indeed, the Catholic Church had difficulty tolerating the exploitation of native populations it was trying to convert. A "Black Legend" of Spanish abuse and butchery soon developed and, through the propaganda of Anglo-Dutch rivals, colored the Spanish national profile for centuries. This encounter between forces of the Old World and the New inaugurated centuries of exploitation and rigid consolidation that set precedents for slaughter and fueled competition among European powers.

The first source describes the initial encounter of the Aztecs with the Spanish explorers in 1519. The Franciscan friar Bernardino de Sahagún was instrumental in preserving information about Aztec culture and the history of this period. His intention was to understand native culture and religious beliefs in order to more effectively convert the Indians to Christianity. His General History of the Things of New Spain *was based on information gained from Aztec eyewitnesses and surviving participants to the conquest of Mexico from 1519 to 1521.*

The succeeding sources are excerpted from letters by Mexico's Spanish conqueror, Hernando Cortés. They lend a valuable perspective to the motives and methods of Spanish conquest in the New World.

The Aztec Encounter: "This Was Quetzalcoatl Who Had Come to Land"

BERNARDINO DE SAHAGÚN

When the first Spanish ships were seen in this land, Montezuma's stewards and captains who lived along the coast of Veracruz immediately assembled and took counsel among themselves, deciding whether they should give this news to their lord Montezuma, who was in the city of Mexico. The chief among them said, "In order for us to take an accurate report of this matter, it seems to me proper that we should see with our own eyes what this is; this we can do if we go to them on the pretext of selling them some things that they have need of." This seemed like a good idea to the others, and at once they took articles of food and clothing, and loaded into canoes what they were going to sell them and went to them by water. When they arrived at the flagship (to which they directed their canoes because of the banner they saw on it), immediately upon arriving they paid homage and gave signs that they came in peace to sell them food and clothing. [It was thought that this was Quetzalcoatl who had come to land.] The Spaniards asked them where they were from and what they came for. They said, "We are Mexicans." The Spaniards said, "If you are Mexicans, tell us who the lord of Mexico is."

The Indians said, "Gentlemen, the lord of Mexico is called Montezuma." Then the Spaniards answered, "Well, come and sell us some things that we need; climb up here and we shall look at them. Have no fear that we shall do you harm." . . . Then [the Indians] climbed into the ship and took with them certain bundles of rich [capes] that they had brought.

They spread them out in front of the Spaniards, who liked them and agreed to buy them, for which they gave the Indians strings of fake precious stones, some red, others green, some blue, others yellow. As they seemed to the Indians to be precious stones, they accepted them, and gave them the

capes. . . . Finally the Spaniards said to them, "God go with you and take those stones to your master and tell him that we are unable to see him now . . . ; we will come again and go to see him in Mexico."

With this they departed in their canoes, and upon reaching land they got ready and departed for Mexico to give the news to Montezuma. . . .

Montezuma: "We Shall Obey You and Hold You As Our God"

HERNANDO CORTÉS

After we had crossed this bridge, Montezuma came to greet us and with him some two hundred lords, all barefoot and dressed in a different costume, but also very rich in their way and more so than the others. They came in two columns, pressed very close to the walls of the street, which is very wide and beautiful and so straight that you can see from one end to the other. . . . Montezuma came down the middle of this street with two chiefs, one on his right hand and the other on his left. . . . When we met I dismounted and stepped forward to embrace him, but the two lords who were with him stopped me with their hands so that I should not touch him; and they likewise all performed the ceremony of kissing the earth. . . .

When at last I came to speak to Montezuma himself I took off a necklace of pearls and cut glass that I was wearing and placed it round his neck; after we had walked a little way up the street a servant of his came with two necklaces, wrapped in a cloth, made from red snails' shells, which they hold in great esteem; and from each necklace hung eight shrimps of refined gold almost a span in length. . . . [Montezuma] took me by the hand and led me to a great room facing the courtyard

through which we entered. And he bade me sit on a very rich throne . . . and addressed me in the following way:

"For a long time we have known from the writings of our ancestors that neither I, nor any of those who dwell in this land, are natives of it, but foreigners who came from very distant parts; and likewise we know that a chieftain, of whom they were all vassals, brought our people to this region. And he returned to his native land and after many years came again, by which time all those who had remained were married to native women and had built villages and raised children. And when he wished to lead them away again they would not go nor even admit him as their chief; and so he departed. And we have always held that those who descended from him would come and conquer this land and take us as their vassals. So because of the place from which you claim to come, namely from where the sun rises, and the things you tell us of the great lord or king who sent you here, we believe and are certain that he is our natural lord, especially as you say that he has known of us for some time. So be assured that we shall obey you and hold you as our lord in place of that great sovereign of whom you speak; and in this there shall be no offense or betrayal whatsoever. And in all the land that lies in my domain, you may command as you will, for you shall be obeyed; and all that we own is for you to dispose of us as you choose. Thus, as you are in your own country and your own house, rest now from the hardships of your journey and the battles which you have fought. . .

Human Sacrifice: "A Most Horrid and Abominable Custom"

HERNANDO CORTÉS

JULY 10, 1519

Most High, Mighty and Excellent Princes, Most Catholic and Powerful Kings and Sovereigns:

[The Aztecs] have a most horrid and abominable custom which truly ought to be punished and which until now we have seen in no other part, and this is that, whenever they wish to ask something of the idols, in order that their plea may find more acceptance, they take many girls and boys and even adults, and in the presence of the idols they open their chests while they are still alive and take out their hearts and entrails and burn them before the idols, offering the smoke as sacrifice. Some of us have seen this, and they say it is the most terrible and frightful thing they have ever witnessed.

This these Indians do so frequently that . . . not one year passes in which they do not kill and sacrifice some fifty persons in each temple. . . . Your Majesties may be most certain that, as this land seems to us to be very large, and to have many temples in it, not one year has passed, as far as we have been able to discover, in which three or four thousand souls have not been sacrificed in this manner.

Let Your Royal Highnesses consider, therefore, whether they should not put an end to such evil practices, for certainly Our Lord God would be well pleased if by the hand of Your Royal Highnesses the people were initiated and instructed in our Holy Catholic Faith, and the devotion, trust and hope which they have in these their idols were transferred to the divine power of God. . . . And we believe that it is not without cause that Our Lord God has been pleased that these parts be discovered in the name of Your Royal Highnesses so that Your Majesties may gain much merit and reward in the sight of God by commanding that these barbarous people be instructed

and by Your hands be brought to the True Faith. For, as far as we have been able to learn, we believe that had we interpreters and other people to explain to them the error of their ways and the nature of the True Faith, many of them, and perhaps even all, would soon renounce their false beliefs and come to the true knowledge of God; for they live in a more civilized and reasonable manner than any other people we have seen in these parts up to the present.

The Destruction of Tenochtitlán: "And Their Mothers Raised a Cry of Weeping"

BERNARDINO DE SAHAGÚN

The following accounts of the brutal destruction of the Aztec capital of Tenochtitlán, first from the native perspective and then from that of Cortés, demonstrate the advantages that the Spanish enjoyed with their armor, weaponry, horses, and sophisticated manipulation of the rivalries and animosities of Aztec enemies. Cortés had difficulty controlling the anger and brutality of his native allies who were released to fight against their Aztec rulers.

The greatest evil that one can do to another is to take his life when [the victim] is in mortal sin. This is what the Spaniards did to the Mexican Indians because they provoked them by being faithless in honoring their idols. [The Spaniards], catching [the Indians] enclosed [in the courtyard] for the feast [of Huitzilopochtli], killed them, the greater part of whom were unarmed, without their knowing why.

When the great courtyard of the idol, Huitzilopochtli, god of the Mexicans, was full of nobles, priests, and soldiers, and throngs of other people, intent upon the idolatrous songs to that idol, whom they were honoring, the Spaniards suddenly poured forth ready for combat and blocked the exits of the courtyard so that no one could escape. Then they entered with their weapons and ranged themselves all along the inner walls of the courtyard. The Indians thought that they were just

admiring the style of their dancing and playing and singing, and so continued the style of their dancing and playing and singing, and so continued with their celebration and songs.

At this moment, the first Spaniards to start fighting suddenly attacked those who were playing the music for the singers and dancers. They chopped off their hands and their heads so that they fell down dead. Then all the other Spaniards began to cut off heads, arms, and legs and to disembowel the Indians. Some had their heads cut off, others were cut in half, and others had their bellies slit open, immediately to fall dead. Others dragged their entrails along until they collapsed. Those who reached the exits were slain by the Spaniards guarding them; and others jumped over the walls of the courtyard; while yet others climbed up the temple; and still others, seeing no escape, threw themselves down among the slaughtered and escaped by feigning death.

So great was the bloodshed that rivers of blood ran through the courtyard like water in a heavy rain. So great was the slime of blood and entrails in the courtyard and so great was the stench that it was both terrifying and heartrending. Now that nearly all were fallen and dead, the Spaniards went searching for those who had climbed up the temple and those who had hidden among the dead, killing all those they found alive. . . .

Seeing themselves hotly pursued by the Mexicans, the Spaniards entered the royal houses and fortified and barricaded themselves as best they could to keep the Indians out. From inside they began to defend themselves, firing off crossbows, [rifles], and cannon, and even aiming stones from the rooftop to drive off the Indians struggling to break down the wall and force their way in.

Having a convenient opportunity, the Spaniards conferred with each other, and also with Montezuma and his courtiers, and decided to put them in irons. Meanwhile, the Mexicans were busy performing burial ceremonies for those who had been killed in the ambush and so delayed a few days

before returning to do battle with the Spaniards. Great was the Indians' mourning over their dead. . . . [And their mothers, their fathers raised a cry of weeping. There was weeping for them. There was weeping.]

"We Could No Longer Endure the Stench of Dead Bodies"

HERNANDO CORTÉS

AUGUST 12, 1521

On leaving my camp, I had commanded Gonzalo de Sandoval to sail the brigantines [ships] in between the houses in the other quarter in which the Indians were resisting, so that we should have them surrounded, but not to attack until he saw that we were engaged. In this way they would be surrounded and so hard pressed that they would have no place to move save over the bodies of their dead or along the roof tops. They no longer had nor could find any arrows, javelins or stones with which to attack us; and our allies fighting with us were armed with swords and bucklers, and slaughtered so many of them on land and in the water that more than forty thousand were killed or taken that day. So loud was the wailing of the women and children that there was not one man among us whose heart did not bleed at the sound; and indeed we had more trouble in preventing our allies from killing with such cruelty than we had in fighting the enemy. For no race, however savage, has ever practiced such fierce and unnatural cruelty as the natives of these parts. Our allies also took many spoils that day, which we were unable to prevent, as they numbered more than 150,000 and we Spaniards were only some nine hundred. Neither our precautions nor our warnings could stop their looting, though we did all we could. One of the reasons why I had avoided entering the city in force during the past days was the fear that if we attempted to storm them they would throw all they

possessed into the water, and, even if they did not, our allies would take all they could find. For this reason I was much afraid that Your Majesty would receive only a small part of the great wealth this city once had, in comparison with all that I once held for Your Highness. Because it was now late, and we could no longer endure the stench of the dead bodies that had lain in those streets for many days, which was the most loathsome thing in all the world, we returned to our camps.

The Devastation of Smallpox

BERNARDINO DE SAHAGÚN

It would be narrow and simplistic to view the Spanish conquest of Mexico and Peru from a military or even cultural perspective alone. For there were even more encompassing societal changes that affected both Europe and the Americas as a result of the encounter. Recent research has noted the importance of the Spanish introduction of horses to the Americas and especially the impact of these horses on the Native American cultures of the Southwest and Plains. In addition, the crops that poured into Europe from the Americas after 1492 included maize, potatoes, sweet potatoes, tomatoes, peanuts, and various kinds of peppers, beans, and squashes. When one considers that the four chief staples of the human diet in our contemporary world are wheat, rice, maize, and potatoes, the impact of the New World on the Old becomes apparent.

But perhaps the most immediate factor in the exchange of European and American cultures was disease. It has been proposed by scholars that syphilis, a disease unknown in Europe before the end of the fifteenth century, was brought to Europe by the Spaniards from America. The Indians suffered from it in a mild form, but it attacked the Spanish more severely. Next to tobacco, it may have been the most harmful gift of the Old World to the New. By the same token, the Spanish brought with them diseases against which the Indians had no resistance. The smallpox as described in the following selection by Sahagún certainly devastated the Aztecs and may have been the pivotal factor in Cortés' success.

After the previously mentioned hardships that befell the Spaniards in the year 1519, at the beginning of the year 1520 the epidemic of smallpox, measles, and pustules broke out so virulently that a vast number of people died throughout this New Spain. This pestilence began in the province of Chalco and lasted for sixty days. Among the Mexicans who fell victim to this pestilence was the lord

Cuitlahuactzin, whom they had elected a little earlier. Many leaders, many veteran soldiers, and valiant men who were their defense in time of war, also died.

During this epidemic, the Spaniards, rested and recovered, were already in Tlaxcala. Having taken courage and energy because of the ravages of the [Mexican] people that the pestilence was causing, firmly believing that God was on their side, being again allied with the Tlaxcalans, and attending to all the necessary preparations to return against the Mexicans, they began to construct the brigantines [ships] that they would need in order to wage war by water.

Consider This:

2) Analyze the sources in the section on the conquest of Mexico. What were Cortés' motives in sailing to Mexico? Why did he decide to destroy the Aztecs after having been accepted as conqueror by Montezuma?

3) Compare the two accounts of Cortés and Sahagún regarding the destruction of Tenochtitlán by the Spanish. How do you explain Cortés' statements that "there was not one man among us whose heart did not bleed at the sound" of the slaughter? Who bears the primary responsibility for the Aztec destruction? Cortés? His Indian allies? Or Montezuma himself? Is Cortés' attitude toward the Amerindians consistent with that of Columbus'? Were they explorers or exploiters?

4) How was Cortés able to defeat thousands of Aztec warriors with only a few hundred soldiers? What role did smallpox play in the destruction of the Aztec civilization in Mexico? Do you agree with historian, William McNeill, that "the main destructive role was certainly played by epidemic disease"? How important is disease as an agent of change in history?

The Spanish Empire in America

With the exploration of America by Christopher Columbus in 1492, the subsequent Spanish conquest of the Aztecs by Hernando Cortés in 1519, and the Incas by Juan Pizarro in 1531, perspectives suddenly changed. This "New World" fired the imagination with the abstraction of discovery–the encounter with strange peoples of different color, perspective, customs, and religions. But it also presented unique tangible opportunities to realize immense national and personal power through regional conquest and consolidation and of untold, mythic wealth through the exploitation and extraction of natural resources.

Thus began one of the most brutal episodes in modern Western history. The Spanish conquistadores *("conquerors") methodically organized the region in order to extract the gold and silver that would allow Spain to surpass its rivals for European power. This was an economy of exploitation that was primarily focused on mining, agriculture, and shipping. There was little accommodation to the native population on the part of the Spanish as European language, values, and religion became the dominant culture of what would be called Latin America.*

Although the Spanish were particularly attracted to gold, silver became the primary metal of Mexico and Bolivia. Since the Spanish crown received one-fifth (the quinto) of all mining revenues, it imposed a monopoly over the production and sale of mercury, which was essential in the process of mining silver. The extraction of silver was such a labor-intensive process that the Spanish developed various systems to compel and organize native workers.

One of the most important was the encomienda*. Influential businessmen (encomenderos) received formal grants to the labor of a specified number of Indians for a limited time. In the silver mines of Potosi, Bolivia, the* mita *or "labor tax" placed on Indians required that they contribute a certain number of days of labor annually to the Spanish authorities. Many of these Indians did not survive their* mita *as conditions in the mines were dangerous and the overseers harsh in their demands.*

The Extraction of Mercury

ANTONIO VASQUEZ DE ESPINOSA

Antonio Vasquez de Espinosa (d. 1630) was a Spanish friar and missionary in the Americas who sought to convert the Indians to Christianity. He returned to Spain in 1622 and wrote several accounts of his experiences. In the following excerpt, he describes the mita *system of forced Indian labor used in the dangerous process of extracting mercury from the mines. He then describes Potosi, the richest silver mine in the world. Such wealth allowed the Spanish government to wage wars in Europe against Protestant forces and contributed to the stability of the Spanish crown.*

And so at the rumor of the rich deposits of mercury...in the years 1570 and 1571, they started the construction of the town of Huancavelica de Oropesa in a pleasant valley at the foot of the range. It contains 400 Spanish residents, as well as many temporary shops of dealers in merchandise and groceries, heads of trading houses, and transients, for the town has a lively commerce....

Every two months His Majesty sends by the regular courier from Lima 60,000 pesos to pay for the mita of the Indians, for the crews are changed every two months, so that merely for the Indian mita payment (in my understanding of it) 360,000 pesos are sent from Lima every year, not to speak

of much besides, which all crosses at his risk that cold and desolate mountain country which is the puna [high plateau] and has nothing on it but llama ranches.

Up on the range there are 3,000 or 4,000 Indians working in the mine; it is colder up there than in the town, since it is higher. The mine where the mercury is located is a large layer which they keep following downward. When I was in that town (which was in the year 1616) I went up on the range and down into the mine, which at that time was considerably more than 130 stades deep [about 104 miles]. The ore was very rich black flint, and the excavation so extensive that it held more than 3,000 Indians working away hard with picks and hammers, breaking up that flint ore; and when they have filled their little sacks, the poor fellows, loaded down with ore, climb up those ladders or rigging, some like masts and others like cable, and so trying and distressing that a man empty-handed can hardly get up them. That is the way they work in this mine, with many lights and the loud noise of the pounding and great confusion. Nor is that the greatest evil and difficulty; that is due to thievish and undisciplined superintendents. As that great vein of ore keeps going down deeper and they follow its rich trail, in order to make sure that no section of that ore shall drop on top of them, they deep leaving supports or pillars of the ore itself, even if of the richest quality, and they necessarily help to sustain and insure each section with less risk. This being so, there are men so heartless that for the sake of stealing a little rich ore, they go down out of hours and deprive the innocent Indians of this protection by hollowing into these pillars to steal the rich ore in them, and then a great section is apt to fall in and kill all the Indians, and sometimes the unscrupulous and grasping superintendents themselves, as happened when I was in that locality; and much of this is kept quiet so that it shall not come to the notice of the manager and cause the punishment of the accomplices....

This is how they extract the mercury. On the other side of the town there are structures where they grind up the mercury ore an then put it in jars with molds like sugar loaves on top of them, with many little holes, and others on top of them, flaring and plastered with mud, and a channel for it to drip into and pass into the jar or place where it is to fall. Then they roast the ore with a straw fire.... Under the onset of this fire it melts and the mercury goes up in vapor...until it cools and coagulates and starts falling downward again. Those who carry out the reduction of this ore have to be very careful and test cautiously; they must wait till the jars are cold before uncovering them for otherwise they may easily get mercury poisoning and if they do, they are of no further use; their teeth fall out, and some die. After melting and extracting the mercury by fire, they put it in dressed sheepskins to keep it in His Majesty's storehouses, and from there they usually transport it on llamaback to the port of Chincha...where there is a vault and an agent appointed by the royal Council, and he has charge of it there; then they freight it on shipboard to the port of San Marcos de Arica, from which it is carried by herds of llamas and mules to Potosi.

The Silver Mines of Potosi

ANTONIO VASQUEZ DE ESPINOSA

The famous Potosi range, so celebrated all over the world for the great wealth which God has created unique in its bowels and veins, lies in the Province of the Charcas, 18 leagues form the city of Chuquisaca, which was later called La Plata, on account of the great richness of this range....

According to His Majesty's warrant, the mine owners on this massive range have a right to the mita of 13,300 Indians in the working and exploitation of the mines, both those which have been discovered, those now discovered, and those which shall be discovered. It is the duty of the

Corregidor of Potosi [a district military officer] to have them rounded up and to see that they come in from all the provinces between Cuzco over the whole of El Collao and as far as the frontiers of Tarija and Tomina; this Potosi Corregidor [official] has power and authority over all the Corregidors in those provinces mentioned; for if they do not fill the Indian mita allotment assigned each of them in accordance with the capacity of their provinces as indicated to them, he can send them, and does, salaried inspectors to report upon it, and when the remissness is great or remarkable, he can suspend them, notifying the Viceroy of the fact.

These Indians are sent out every year under a captain whom they choose in each village or tribe, for him to take them and oversee them for the year each has to serve; every year they have a new election, for as some go out, others come in. This works out very badly, with great losses and gaps in the quotas of Indians, the villages being depopulated; and this gives rise to great extortions and abuses on the part of the inspectors toward the poor Indians, ruining them and thus depriving the chief Indians of their property and carrying them off in chains because they do not fill out the mita assignment, which they cannot do, for the reason given and for others which I do not bring forward.

These 13,300 are divided up every four months into three mitas, each consisting of 4,443 Indians, to work in the mines on the range and in the 120 smelters in the Potosi and Tarapaya areas; it is a good league [three miles] between the two. These mita Indians earn each day, or there is paid each one for his labor, four reals [Spanish silver coins]....

After each [Indian] has eaten his ration, they climb up the hill, each to his mine, and go in, staying there from that hour until Saturday evening without coming out of the mine; their wives bring them food, but they stay constantly underground, excavating and carrying out the ore from

which they get the silver. They all have tallow candles, lighted day and night; that is the light they work with, for as they are underground, they have need of it all the time....

So huge is the wealth which has been taken out of this range since the year 1545, when it was discovered, up to the present year of 1628, which makes 83 years that they have been working and reducing its ores, that merely form the registered mines, as appears from an examination of most of the accounts in the royal records, 326,000,000 pesos have been taken out.

Over and above that, such great treasure and riches have come from the Indies in gold and silver from all the other mines in New Spain and Peru, Honduras, the New Kingdom of Granada, chile, New Galicia, New Vzcaya [north central and northwestern Mexico], and other quarters since the discovery of the Indies, that they exceed 1,800 millions.

Consider This:

5) What was the *encomienda* system and how were it and the *mita* used to exploit Indian labor? How was the mercury extracted from the mines and why was this a dangerous process? Why were the silver mines of Potosi so important to the Spanish and what made them such a lucrative operation?

The Barbarians of the New World: "They Are Slaves By Nature"

JUAN GINES DE SEPULVEDA

Juan Gines de Sepulveda (1490-1573) was a scholar and apologist for the Spanish treatment of Indians in the Americas. His argument, in essence, is one that would be echoed by conquerors of later ages, from the nineteenth century British imperialists and American Social Darwinists, to the Nazis of the twentieth century: Superior peoples had the right to enslave inferior peoples. For Sepulveda, the Aztecs were stupid, cruel, immoral, and deserved destruction; they were "natural slaves." Note how his argument is repeated four hundred years later by Sir Frederick Lugard in East Africa and countered by Bartolomé de Las Casas in the succeeding source.

Turning then to our topic, whether it is proper and just that those who are superior and who excel in nature, customs, and laws rule over their inferiors, you can easily understand...if you are familiar with the character and moral code of the two peoples, that it is with perfect right that the Spaniards exercise their dominion over those barbarians of the New World and its adjacent islands. For in prudence, talent, and every kind of virtue and human sentiment they are as inferior to the Spaniards as children are to adults, or women to men, or the cruel and inhumane to the very gentle, or the excessively intemperate to the continent and moderate....

And what shall I say of [Spanish] moderation in rejecting gluttony and lasciviousness, inasmuch as no nation or very few nations of Europe can compare with the frugality and sobriety of the Spaniards? I admit that I have observed in these most recent times that through contact with foreigners luxury has invaded the tables of our nobles. Still, since this is reproved by good men among the people, it is to be hoped that in a short while they may return to the traditional and innate sobriety of our native custom....

As for the Christian religion, I have witnessed many clear proofs of the firm roots it has in the hearts of Spaniards, even those dedicated to the military.... What shall I say of the Spanish soldiers' gentleness and humanitarian sentiments? Their only and great solicitude and care in the battles, after the winning of the victory is to save the greatest possible number of vanquished and free them from the cruelty of their allies. Now compare these qualities of prudence, skill, magnanimity, moderation, humanity, and religion with those of those little men [of America] in whom one can scarcely find any remnants of humanity. They not only lack culture but do not even use or know about writing or preserve records of their history–save for some obscure memory of certain deeds contained painting. They lack written laws and their institutions and customs are barbaric. And as

for their virtues, if you wish to be informed of their moderation and mildness, what can be expected of men committed to all kinds of passion and nefarious lewdness and of whom not a few are given to the eating of human flesh. Do not believe that their life before the coming of the Spaniards was one of ...peace, of the kind that poets sang about. On the contrary, they made war with each other almost continuously, and with such fury that they considered a victory to be empty if they could not satisfy their prodigious hunger with the flesh of their enemies....But in other respects they are so cowardly and timid that they can scarcely offer any resistance to the hostile presence of our side, and many times thousands and thousands of them have been dispersed and have fled like women, on being defeated by a small Spanish force scarcely amounting to one hundred....

Could there be a better or clearer testimony of the superiority that some men have over others in talent, skill, strength of spirit, and virtue? Is it not proof that they are slaves by nature? For the fact that some of them appear to have a talent for certain manual tasks is no argument for their greater human prudence. We see that certain insects, such as the bees and the spiders, produce works that no human skill can imitate....

I have made reference to the customs and character of the barbarians. What shall I say now of the impious religion and wicked sacrifices of such people, who, in venerating the devil as if he were God, believed that the best sacrifice that they could placate him with was to offer him human hearts?...Opening up the human breasts they pulled out the hearts and offered them on their heinous altars. And believing that they had made a ritual sacrifice with which to placate their gods, they themselves ate the flesh of the victims. These are crimes that are considered by the philosophers to be among the most ferocious and abominable perversions, exceeding all human iniquity....

How can we doubt that these people–so uncivilized, so barbaric, contaminated with so many impieties and obscenities–have been justly conquered by...a nation excellent in every kind of virtue, with the best law and best benefit for the barbarians? Prior to the arrival of the Christians they had the nature, customs, religion, and practice of evil sacrifice as we have explained. Now, on receiving with our rule our writing, laws, and morality, imbued with the Christian religion, having shown themselves to be docile to the missionaries that we have sent them, as many have done, they are as different from their primitive condition as civilized people are from barbarians, or as those with sight from the blind, as the inhuman from the meek, as the pious from the impious, or to put it in a single phrase, in effect, as men from beasts.

The "Black Legend" of Spain

BARTOLOMÉ DE LAS CASAS

More than any other single individual, the Dominican friar Bartolomé de Las Casas was responsible for the birth of the "Black Legend," the vicious Spanish reputation that developed during the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries. Although the Black Legend became primarily an instrument of Anglo-Dutch propaganda against the Spanish, which Las Casas probably would never have accepted, his influence in its creation is undeniable. After witnessing the ravages and atrocities of Spanish colonists, Las Casas dedicated himself to the protection and defense of the Indians. He wrote the Short Account of the Destruction of the Indies *in 1542 and dedicated it to the Spanish king Philip II in an effort to inform the crown of atrocities in the New World that, if not curtailed, would result in God's destruction of Spain. This book, a fierce and deeply atmospheric anatomy of genocide, established the image of the Spanish conquest of America for the next three centuries. It is testimony to the persuasive and enduring influence of the Black Legend that the Spanish government hoped to amend this pejorative image by hosting the 1992 Olympics in Barcelona.*

As we have said, the island of Hispaniola was the first to witness the arrival of Europeans and the first to suffer the wholesale slaughter of its people and the devastation and depopulation of the land. It all began with the Europeans taking native women and children both as servants and to satisfy their own base appetites; then not content with what the local people offered them of their own free will

(and all offered as much as they could spare), they started taking for themselves the food that natives contrived to produce by the sweat of their brows, (which was in all honesty little enough). . . . Some of them started to conceal what food they had, others decided to send their women and children into hiding, and yet others took to the hills to get away from the brutal and ruthless cruelty that was being inflicted on them. The Christians punched them, boxed their ears and flogged them in order to track down the local leaders, and the whole shameful process came to a head when one of the European commanders raped the wife of the paramount chief of the entire island. It was then that the locals began to think up ways of driving the Europeans out of their lands and to take up arms against them. Their weapons, however, were flimsy and ineffective both in attack and in defense (and, indeed, war in the Americas is no more deadly than our jousting, or than many European children's games) and, with their horses and swords and lances, the Spaniards easily fended them off, killing them and committing all kind of atrocities against them.

They forced their way into native settlements, slaughtering everyone they found there, including small children, old men, pregnant women, and even women who had just given birth. They hacked them to pieces, slicing open their bellies with their swords as though they were so many sheep herded into a pen. They even laid wagers on whether they could manage to slice a man in two at a stroke, or cut an individual's head from his body, or disembowel him with a single blow of their axes. They grabbed suckling infants by the feet and, ripping them from their mothers' breasts, dashed them headlong against the rocks. . . . They slaughtered anyone and everyone in their path, on occasion running through a mother and her baby with a single thrust of their swords. They spared no one, erecting especially wide gibbets on which they could string their victims up with their feet just off the ground and then burn them alive thirteen at a time, in honor of our Savior and the twelve

Apostles, or tie dry straw to their bodies and set fire to it. Some they chose to keep alive and simply cut their wrists, leaving their hands dangling, saying to them: "Take this letter"—meaning that their sorry condition would act as a warning to those hiding in the hills. The way they normally dealt with the native leaders and nobles was to tie them to a kind of griddle consisting of sticks resting on pitchforks driven into the ground and then grill them over a slow fire, with the result that they howled in agony and despair as they died a lingering death.

6) What was the "Black Legend" of Spain? What types of atrocities were committed by the Spanish conquistadores? Study the pictures accompanying the accounts of Bartolomé de Las Casas. Was this an attempt at genocide, or have these atrocities been blown out of proportion by Las Casas and inflated as anti-Spanish propaganda? Do the arguments of Juan Gines de Sepulveda effectively counter those of Las Casas? How does Sepulveda justify Spanish treatment of the Indians?

Theme: Imperialism

The Historical Intersection

EAST AFRICA: 1893

"A Natural Inclination to Submit to a Higher Authority"

SIR FREDERICK DEALTRY LUGARD

Probably the most obvious motive for imperialism is in the economic profit to be made from the colonization of territory and the subjugation of people. Sir Frederick Lugard, soldier and administrator of some of Britain's colonial possessions in the late nineteenth century, analyzed the European "scramble for Africa" in the nineteenth century.

Compare and Contrast:

7) Compare Lugard's assessment of Africans with Juan Gines de Sepulveda's opinion of Native Americans in the preceding account. What are the arguments for European supremacy? Why must African natives and American Indians be deprived of their independence and subdued?

The "Scramble for Africa" by the nations of Europe—an incident without parallel in the history of the world—was due to the growing commercial rivalry, which brought home to civilised nations the vital necessity of securing the only remaining fields for industrial enterprise and expansion. It is well, then, to realise that it is for our advantage—and not alone at the dictates of duty—that we have undertaken responsibilities in East Africa. It is in order to foster the growth of the trade of this country, and to find an outlet for our manufactures and our surplus energy, that our far-seeing statesmen and our commercial men advocate colonial expansion. . . .

There are some who say we have no right in Africa at all, that "it belongs to the natives." I hold that our right is the necessity that is upon us to provide for our ever-growing population—either by opening new fields for emigration, or by providing work and employment which the development of over-sea extension entails—and to stimulate trade by finding new markets, since we know what misery trade depression brings at home.

While thus serving our own interests as a nation, we may, by selecting men of the right stamp for the control of new territories, bring at the same time many advantages to Africa. Nor do we deprive the natives of their birthright of freedom, to place them under a foreign yoke. It has ever been the key-note of British colonial method to rule through and by the natives, and it is this method, in contrast to the arbitrary and uncompromising rule of Germany, France, Portugal, and Spain, which has been the secret of our success as a colonising nation, and has made us welcomed by tribes and peoples in Africa, who ever rose in revolt against the other nations named. In Africa, moreover, there is among the people a natural inclination to submit to a higher authority. That intense detestation of control which animates our Teutonic races does not exist among the tribes of Africa, and if there is any authority that we replace, it is the authority of the Slavers and Arabs, or the intolerable tyranny of the "dominant tribe."

Consider This:

8) The "dehumanization" of an enemy has been standard procedure for nations engaged in war or imperialistic activities. How did Lugard and Sepulveda dehumanize natives? To what extent must war be accompanied by the justification of propaganda?

And How About...

- The dehumanization of American Indians by the United States government in the late nineteenth century?

- The Japanese dehumanization of the Chinese and “Rape of Nanking” during the invasion of Manchuria in 1936?
- The Serbian dehumanization of ethnic Albanians in Kosovo in 1998?

Links to Africa and India

Mali: "The Land of Gold"

The kingdom of Mali near the Niger River region of West Africa was founded in the mid-thirteenth century by the Keita ruling clan, which had converted to Islam about 1100. Agriculture provided the foundation of Mali's economy, but it was a monopoly of the lucrative north-south gold trade that allowed the Keita kings to prosper. Ultimately, Mali controlled all trade on the upper Niger river and linked it to western markets served by the Gambia and Senegal rivers.

Mali's imperial power was founded primarily by the Keita King Sundiata ®. 1230-1255), who established a vast network of influence, including provinces and tribute-paying kingdoms whose chieftains recognized the sovereignty of the sacred mansa *or supreme emperor of all the Malian realms. Perhaps the greatest of Sundiata's successors was the famous Mansa Musa (r. 1312-1337). A devout Muslim, Mansa Musa consolidated his realm and with the blessings of peace, imported Muslim scholars and architects, poets and scientists. The fabled trading city of Timbuktu, with its splendid libraries and Islamic schools, became the intellectual center of sub-Saharan Islam. By the fifteenth century, however, factional fighting for succession to the* mansa's *throne had sent Mali into sharp decline.*

The following source is an excellent example of what has been termed "historical oratory." Although western scholars have concentrated primarily on written sources of history, the stories of African tribes were handed down through oral traditions by griots *or singers, who might be likened to poets or troubadours in the West. The African* griot *was, in fact, a most respected and valued member of society. He was often the advisor and tutor of kings and was appointed to preserve the traditions of the tribe. The following selection is perhaps the greatest epic of old Mali to have been preserved by this oral tradition. It is the story of the Lion King, Sundiata. It begins with the words of the* griot*, Mamoudou Kouyaté, who then launches into the tale of Sundiata's struggle for power against Soumaoro Kanté, the sorcerer king of Sasso.*

The Victory of Sundiata

MAMOUDOU KOUYATÉ

I am a griot. It is I, Djeli Mamoudou Koyaté, son of Bintou Kouyaté and Kedian Kouyaté, master in the art of eloquence. Since time immemorial the Kouyatés have been in the service of the Keita princes of Mali; we are vessels of speech, we are the repositories which harbor secrets many centuries old. The art of eloquence has no secrets for us; without us the names of kings would vanish into oblivion, we are the memory of mankind; by the spoken word we bring to life the deeds and exploits of kings for younger generations....

Listen to my word, you who want to know; by my mouth you will learn the history of Mali.

Listen now to the story of Sundiata, the Na"Kamma, the man who had a mission to accomplish.

At the time when Sundiata was preparing to assert his claim over the kingdom of his fathers, Soumaoro was the King of Kings, the most powerful king in all the lands of the setting sun. The fortified town of Sosso was the bulwark of fetishism against the word of Allah. For a long time Soumaoro defied the whole world. Since his accession to the throne of Sosso he had defeated nine kings whose heads served him as fetishes in his macabre chamber. Their skins served as seats and he cut his footwear from human skin. Soumaoro was not like other men, for his power was beyond measure. So his countless warriors were very brave since they believed their king to be invincible. But Soumaoro was an evil demon and his reign had produced nothing but bloodshed. Nothing was taboo for him. His greatest pleasure was publicly to flog venerable old men. He had defiled every family and everywhere in his vast empire there were villages populated by girls whom he had forcibly abducted from their families without marrying them. Oh! How power can pervert a man....

Soumaoro proclaimed himself king of Mali by right of conquest, but he was not recognized by the populace and resistance was organized in the bush. Soothsayers were consulted as to the fate of the country. The soothsayers were unanimous in saying that it would be the rightful heir to the throne who would save Mali. This heir was "The Man with Two Names." The man with two names was no other than Maghan Sundiata....

Soumaoro sent a detachment under his son, Sosso Balla, to block Sundiata"s route Tabon. Sosso Balla was about the same age as Sundiata. He promptly deployed his troops at the entrance to the mountains to oppose Sundiata"s advance to Tabon.

In the evening, after a long day"s march, Sundiata arrived at the head of the great valley which led to Tabon. The valley was quite black with men, for Sosso Balla had deployed his men everywhere in the valley, and some were positioned on the heights which dominated the way through. When Sundiata saw the layout of Sosso Balla"s men, he turned to his generals laughing.

"Why are you laughing, brother," said one of his generals, "you can see that the road is blocked."

"Yes, but no mere infantrymen can halt my course towards Mali," replied Sundiata.

The troops stopped. All the war chiefs were of the opinion that they should wait until the next day to give battle because, they said, the men were tired.

"The battle will not last long," said Sundiata, "and the men will have time to rest. We must not allow Soumaoro the time to attack Tabon."

Sundiata was immovable, so the orders were given and the war drums began to beat. On his proud horse, Sundiata turned to right and left in front of his troops.... Having drawn his sword, Sundiata led the charge, shouting his war cry.

The Sossos were surprised by this sudden attack for they all thought that the battle would be joined the next day. The lightning that flashes across the sky is slower, the thunderbolts less frightening and flood waters less surprising than Sundiata swooping down on Sosso Balla and his warriors. In a second, Sundiata was in the middle of the Sossos like a lion in the sheepfold. The Sossos, trampled under the hooves of his fiery charger, cried out. When he turned to the right the warriors of Soumaoro fell in their tens, and when he turned to the left his sword made heads fall as when someone shakes a tree of ripe fruit. The horsemen of Mema [Sundiata"s army] wrought a frightful slaughter and their long lances pierced flesh like a knife.... Charging ever forward, Sundiata looked for Sosso Balla; he caught sight of him and like a lion bounded towards the son of Soumaoro, his sword held aloft. His arm came sweeping down, but at that moment a Sosso warrior came between him and Sosso Balla and was sliced like a calabash. Sosso Balla did not wait and disappeared from amidst his warriors. Seeing their chief in flight, the Sossos gave way and fell into a terrible rout.... The Sossos were pursued until nightfall and several of them were taken prisoner.

The victory had fallen to Sundiata, the son of Sogolon, [and] there was an all-night celebration in the very valley where the Sossos had been defeated.... At break of day, the victors entered impregnable Tabon to the cheering of women standing on the ramparts.

The news of the battle of Tabon spread like wildfire throughout the plains of Mali. It was known that Soumaoro was not present at the battle, but the mere fact that his troops had retreated before Sundiata sufficed to give hope to all the peoples of Mali. Soumaoro realized that from now on he would have to reckon with this young man, Sundiata. When Sosso Balla returned with the remnant [of his army] he had managed to save at Tabon, he said to Soumaoro: "Father, he is worse than a lion; nothing can withstand him."

Consider This:

9) In the griot account of the struggle between the sorcerer king, Soumaoro, and Sundiata for the control of Mali, what qualities of heroism did Sundiata display? Why are heroes important to each civilization? The African griot, Mamoudou Koyaté, was aware of his value as the "memory of mankind." Do you regard oral history as legitimate history? Must history be based on written sources?

The Kingdom of Mali

IBN BATTUTA

For Muslim traders from North Africa, the kingdom of Mali loomed large in the imagination. Trading salt across the Sahara desert for the gold of Mali was a difficult, but rewarding opportunity that inspired a linkage between different cultural worlds.

The following sources are from the pen of Abu Abdallah Muhammad ibn Battuta (1304-1369), who lived a life of great adventure. In 1325, he left home in Morocco on a pilgrimage to Mecca. Inspired by what he saw along the way, he continued to travel, moving mostly within the cultural boundaries of Islam from Spain to Russia and India, to southeast Asia, all the way to China. In 1352, before he settled down to write about all that he had seen, he left by caravan for Mali, the fabled "land of gold." His observations of the customs of Africans often shocked him, but give real indication of the variety of life within the Islamic world.

We set out thereafter from Karsakhu and came to the river of Sansara, which is about ten miles from Mali.... I saw a crocodile in this part of the Nile, close to the bank; it looked just like a small boat. One day I went down to the river to satisfy a need, and lo, one of the blacks came and stood between me and the river. I was amazed at such lack of manners and decency on his part, and spoke of it to someone or other. He answered, "His purpose in doing that was solely to protect you from the crocodile, by placing himself between you and it."...

The Negroes [of Mali] possess some admirable qualities. They are seldom unjust, and have a greater abhorrence of injustice than any other people. The sultan of Mali [called *mansa*] shows no mercy to anyone who is guilty of the least act of it. There is complete security in their country.

Neither traveler nor inhabitant in it has anything to fear from robbers or men of violence. They do not confiscate the property of any white man who dies in their country, even if it be accounted wealth. On the contrary, they give it into the charge of some trustworthy person among the whites, until the rightful heir takes possession of it. They are careful to observe the hours of prayer, and assiduous in attending them in congregations, and in bring up their children to them. On Fridays, if a man does not go early to the mosque, he cannot find a corner to pray in , on account of the crowd. It is a custom of theirs to send each man his boy (to the mosque) with his prayer-mat; the boy spreads it out for his master in a place befitting him and remains on it (until his master comes to the mosque). The prayer-mats are made of the leaves of a tree resembling a date-palm, but without fruit.

Another of their good qualities is their habit of wearing clean white garments on Fridays. Even if a man has nothing but an old worn shirt, he washes it and cleans it, and wears it at the Friday service. Yet another is their zeal for learning the Qur'an by heart. They put their children in chains if they show any backwardness in memorizing it, and they are not set free until they have it by heart. I visited his house on the day of the festival. His children were chained up, so I said to him, "Will you not let them loose?" He replied, "I shall not do so until they learn the Qur'an by heart." Among their bad qualities are the following. The women servants, slave-girls, and young girls go about in front of everyone naked, without a stitch of clothing on them. Women go into the sultan's presence naked and without coverings, and his daughters also go about naked. Then there is the custom of their putting dust and ashes on their heads as a mark of respect, and the grotesque ceremonies we have described when the poets recite their verses. Another reprehensible practice among many of them is the eating of carrion, dogs, and asses.

The Women of Mali

IBN BATTUTA

The women have their "friends" and "companions" among the men outside their own families, and the men in the same way have "companions" among the women of other families. A man may go into his house and find his wife entertaining her "companion" but he takes no objection to it. One day at Walata, I went into the *qadi's* [Muslim judge] house; after asking his permission to enter, and found with him a young woman of remarkable beauty. When I saw her I was shocked and turned to go out, but she laughed at me, instead of being overcome by shame, and the *qadi* said to me, "Why are you going out? She is my companion." I was amazed at their conduct, for he was a theologian and a pilgrim to boot. I was told that he had asked the sultan's permission to make the pilgrimage that year with his "companion" (whether this one or not I cannot say), but the sultan would not grant it.

The Portuguese in Africa and India

Portugal was to play a primary role in the exploration of new worlds. The Portuguese had traditionally made their living on the sea both as fishermen and as traders, but the leadership of Prince Henry the Navigator (reigned 1394-1468) organized and intensified Portuguese exploration. Henry, inspired both by mercenary motives and missionary ideals sponsored a series of explorations of the African coast in an effort to compete with Muslims, who controlled the land routes of the gold trade. In addition to the lure of gold, the Portuguese saw opportunity in the spice trade of the East and sought to establish outposts that would provide access to new markets and the possibility of commercial dominance.

Explorers such as Bartholomew Dias in 1487 and Vasco da Gama in 1498 rounded the Cape of Good Hope at the tip of Africa and sailed east to India. The first ventures were especially lucrative; da Gama returned with a cargo worth sixty times the cost of the voyage. The Portuguese soon established themselves on the Malabar coast of western India with colonies in Goa and Calcutta. So effective were they in organizing and exploiting commercial links that by the sixteenth century, the Portuguese had successfully challenged the Arabs and Venetians for control of the European spice trade. By the next century, Portuguese contact extended to Japan and other lands in the Far East.

But the establishment of these commercial colonies came at a distinct price for the inhabitants of those regions. In the following selection, Duarte Barbosa (ca. 1480-1521), an agent of the Portuguese government who helped establish commercial contacts along the east African coast, gives a description of the people and products of the area, and of Portuguese methods for controlling trade.

The East Coast of Africa

DUARTE BARBOSA

SOFALA

Going forward in the direction of India there is a river of no great size upon which up the stream is a town of the Moors [African Muslims] which they call Sofala, close to which the King our Lord [Portuguese King Manuel I] possesses a fort. These Moors have dwelt there a long time by reason of the great traffic which they carried on with the heathen of the mainland. The Moors of this place speak Arabic and have a king over them who is subject to the King our Lord.

And the manner of their traffic was this: they came in small vessels named zambucos from the kingdoms of Kilwa, Mombasa, and Malindi, bringing many cotton cloths, some spotted and others white and blue; also some of silk, and many small beads, grey, red, and yellow, which things come to the said kingdoms from the great kingdom of Cambay [on the coast of northwest India] in other greater ships. And these wares the said Moors who came from Malindi and Mombasa paid for in gold at such a price that those merchants departed well pleased...

KILWA

Going along the coast from the town of Mozambique, there is an island hard by the mainland which is called Kilwa, in which is a Moorish town with many fair houses of stone and mortar, with many windows after our fashion, very well arranged in streets, with many flat roofs. The doors are of wood, well carved, with excellent joinery. Around it are streams and orchards and fruit-gardens with many

channels of sweet water. It has a Moorish king over it...Before the King our Lord sent out his expedition to discover India, the Moors of Sofala, Cuama, Angoya and Mozambique were all subject to the King of Kilwa, who was the most mighty king among them. And in this town was great plenty of gold, as no ships passed toward Sofala without first coming to this island...

This town was taken by force from its king by the Portuguese, as, moved by arrogance, he refused to obey the King our Lord. There took many prisoners and the king fled from the island, and His Highness ordered that a fort should be built there, and kept it under his rule and governance....

MOMBASA

Further on, an advance along the coast toward India, there is an isle hard by the mainland, on which is a town called Mombasa.... This Mombasa is a land very full of food. Here are found many very fine sheep with round tails, cows and other cattle in great plenty, and many fowls, all of which are exceedingly fat. There is much millet and rice, sweet and bitter oranges, lemons, pomegranates, Indian figs, vegetables of diverse kinds, and much sweet water. The men are often times at war...but at peace with those of the mainland, and they carry on trade with them, obtaining great amounts of honey, wax, and ivory.

The king of this city refused to obey the commands of the King our Lord, and through this arrogance he lost it, and our Portuguese took it from him by force. He fled away, and they slew many of his people and also took captive many, both men and women, in such sort that it was left ruined and plundered and burned. Of gold and silver great booty was taken here, bangles, bracelets, earrings and gold beads, also great store of copper with other rich wares in great quantity, and the town was left in ruins.

THE CITY OF BRAVA

Yet further along the coast, beyond these places, is a great town of Moors, of very fine stone and mortar houses, called Brava. It has no king, but is ruled by elders, and ancients of the land, who are the persons held in the highest esteem, and who have the chief dealings in merchandise of diverse kinds. And this place was destroyed by the Portuguese, who slew many of its people and carried many into captivity, and took great spoil of gold and silver and goods. Thenceforth many of them fled away toward the inland country, forsaking the town; yet after had been destroyed the Portuguese again settled and peopled it, so that now it is as prosperous as it was before.

Consider This:

10) In the description of the east coast of Africa by Duarte Barbosa, what does he find most important and impressive? What is the Portuguese method of doing business? How does Barbosa justify the destruction of African cities?

"Our Kingdom Is Being Lost"

NZINGA MBEMBA (AFONSO I)

The next selection is a letter from the African King of Kongo, Nzinga Mbemba, who had converted to Christianity and adopted the name Afonso I (reigned ca. 1506-1543). Afonso had hoped to develop a prosperous state by cooperating with the Europeans. But by the time of his death, his kingdom had almost disintegrated. His concerns are expressed in a letter to the Portuguese king, Joao III, in 1526. It was evident that Portuguese exploitation and aggressive pursuit of slaves resulted in dissension and instability throughout the region.

Sir, Your Highness should know how our Kingdom is being lost in so many ways that it is convenient to provide for the necessary remedy, since this is caused by the excessive freedom given by your agents and officials to the men and merchants who are allowed to come to this Kingdom to set up shops with goods and many things which have been prohibited by us, and which they spread

throughout our Kingdoms and Domains in such an abundance that many of our vassals, whom we had in obedience, do not comply because they have the things in greater abundance than we ourselves; and it was with these things that we had them content and subjected under our vassalage and jurisdiction, so it is doing a great harm not only to the service of God, but the security and peace of our Kingdoms and State as well.

And we cannot reckon how great the damage is, since the mentioned merchants are taking every day our natives, sons of the land and the sons of our noblemen and vassals and our relatives, because the thieves and men of bad conscience grab them wishing to have the things and wares of this Kingdom which they are ambitious of; they grab them and get them to be sold; and so great, Sir, is the corruption and licentiousness that our country is being completely depopulated, and Your Highness should not agree with this nor accept it as in your service. And to avoid it we need from your Kingdoms no more than some priests and a few people to teach in schools, and no other goods except wine and flour for the holy sacrament. That is why we beg of Your Highness to help and assist us in this matter, commanding your factors [agents] that they should not send here either merchants or wares, because it *our will that in these Kingdoms there should not be any trade of slaves nor outlet for them*. Concerning what is referred [to] above, again we beg of Your Highness to agree with it, since otherwise we cannot remedy such an obvious damage. Pray Our Lord in his mercy to have Your Highness under His guard and let you do forever the things of His service....

Moreover, Sir, in our Kingdoms there is another great inconvenience which is of little service to God, and this is that many of our people, keenly desirous as they are of the wares and things of your Kingdoms, which are brought here by your people, and in order to satisfy their voracious appetite, seize many of our people, freed and exempt men, and very often it happens that they kidnap even

noblemen and the sons of noblemen, and our relatives, and take them to be sold to the white men who are in our Kingdoms; and for this purpose they have concealed them; and others are brought during the night so that they might not be recognized.

And as soon as they are taken by the white men they are immediately ironed and branded with fire, and when they are carried to be embarked, if they are caught by our guards' men the whites allege that they have bought them but they cannot say from whom, so that it is our duty to do justice and to restore to the freemen their freedom, but it cannot be done if your subjects feel offended, as they claim to be.

And to avoid such a great evil we passed a law so that any white man living in our Kingdoms and wanting to purchase goods in any way should first inform three of our noblemen and officials of our court whom we rely upon in this matter, and these are Dom Pedro Manipanza and Dom Manuel Manissaba, our chief usher, and Gocalo Pires our chief freighter, who should investigate if the mentioned goods are captives or free men, and if cleared by them there will be no further doubt nor embargo for them to be taken and embarked. But if the white men do not comply with it they will lose the aforementioned goods. And if we do them this favor and concession it is for the part Your Highness has in it, since we know that it is in your service too that these goods are taken from our Kingdom, otherwise we should not consent to this....

"Cut off Their Ears, Hands and Noses!"

GASPAR CORREA

The following selection is an excerpt from the journals of Gaspar Correa, who sailed with Vasco da Gama in 1502. This incident occurred after a group of Portuguese had been killed in the trading station of Calcutta. Vasco da Gama sought to control the situation by exacting a bloody vengeance.

The captain-major [Vasco da Gama], on arriving at Calecut, was in the passion because he found the port cleared, and in it there was nothing to which he could do harm, because the Moors, knowing of his coming, had all fled, and hid their vessels and sambuks in the rivers.... The King of Calecut thought that he might gain time, so that the captain-major should not do him harm; and when his fleet arrived he sent him a Brahman [religious official] of his in a boat with a white cloth fastened to a pole, as a sign of peace. This Brahman came dressed in the habit of a friar, one of those who had been killed in the country; and on reaching the ship, he asked for a safe conduct to enter. When it was known that he was not a friar–for the captain-major and everyone had been joyful, thinking that he was one of our friars–seeing that he was not, the captain-major gave him a safe conduct, and bade him enter the ship.... He then ordered all the fleet to draw in close to the shore, and all day, till night, he bombarded the city, by which he made a great destruction....

While they were doing this business, there came in from the offing two large ships and twenty-two sambuks and Malabar vessels, which came from Coromandel laden with rice, which the Moors of Calecut had ordered to be laden there;...but our fleet having sighted them, the [Portuguese] caravels went to them, and the Moors could not fly, as they were laden, and the caravels brought them to the captain-major, and all struck their sails....

Then, the captain-major commanded them to cut off the hands and ears and noses of all the crews, and put all that into one of the small vessels, into which he ordered them to put the friar, also

without ears, or nose, or hands, which he ordered to be strung round his neck, with a palm-leaf for the King, on which he told him to have a curry made to eat of what his friar brought him. When all the Indians had been thus executed, he ordered their feet to be tied together, as they had no hands with which to untie them: and in order that they should not untie them with their he ordered them to strike upon their teeth with staves, and they knocked them down their throats; and they were thus put on board, heaped up upon the top of each other, mixed up with the blood which streamed from them; and he ordered mats and dry leaves to be spread over them, and the sails to be set for the shore, and the vessel set on fire; and there were more than eight hundred Moors; and the small vessel with the friar, with all the hands and ears, was also sent on shore under sail, without being fired. These vessels went at once on shore, where many people flocked together to put out the fire, and draw out those whom they found alive, upon which they made great lamentations.

Consider This:

11) In his correspondence with the Portuguese king, what matters were of the gravest concern to the King of Kongo, Afonso I? Why was his kingdom "out of balance" and what reforms did he suggest? Does Afonso's predicament reveal a Portuguese policy of political and commercial exploitation consistent with the description given by Duarte Barbosa in the previous selection? What does the account of mutilation in the following selection by Gaspar Correa say about Portuguese methods of control? Is a trading relationship based on fear a good commercial policy?

The Prospects of Christian Conversion

SAINT FRANCIS XAVIER

My own and only Father in the Heart of Christ, I think that the many letters from this place which have lately been sent to Rome will inform you how prosperously the affairs of religion go on in these parts, through your prayers and the good bounty of God. But there seem to be certain things which

I ought myself to speak about to you; so I will just touch on a few points relating to these parts of the world which are so distant from Rome. In the first place, the whole race of the Indians, as far as I have been able to see, is very barbarous; and it does not like to listen to anything that is not agreeable to its own manners and customs, which, as I say, are barbarous. It troubles itself very little to learn anything about divine things and things which concern salvation. Most of the Indians are of vicious disposition, and are adverse to virtue. Their instability, levity, and inconstancy of mind are incredible; they have hardly any honesty, so inveterate are their habits of sin and cheating. We have hard work here, both in keeping the Christians up the mark and in this account you should take great care of us and help us continually by your prayers to God. You know very well what a hard business it is to teach people who neither have any knowledge of God nor follow reason, but think it a strange and intolerable thing to be told to give up their habits of sin, which have now gained all the force of nature by long possession...

The experience which I have of these countries makes me think that I can affirm with truth, that there is no prospect of perpetuating our Society out here by means of the natives themselves, and that the Christian religion will hardly survive us who are now in the country; so that it is quite necessary that continual supplies of ours should be sent out from Europe....

The Portuguese in these countries are masters only of the sea and of the coast. On the mainland they have only the towns in which they live. The natives themselves are so enormously addicted to vice as to be little adapted to receive the Christian religion. They so dislike it that it is most difficult to get them to hear us if we begin to preach about it, and they think it like death to be asked to become Christians. So for the present, we devote ourselves to keeping the Christians whom we have. Certainly, if the Portuguese were more remarkable for their kindness to the new converts,

a great number would become Christians; as it is, the heathen see that the converts, are despised and looked down upon by the Portuguese, and so, as is natural, they are unwilling to become converts themselves. For all these reasons there is no need for me to labor in these countries, and as I have learned from good authorities that there is a country near China called Japan, the inhabitants of which are all heathen, quite untouched by Muslims or Jews, and very eager to learn what they do not know both in things divine and things natural, I have determined to go thither as soon as I can....

The Light in the East

The Ming Dynasty of China (1368-1644)

By about 1365, Mongol control of China under the Yuan dynasty had collapsed amidst the furious rioting of peasants, who had for decades endured the dislocation of floods, famines, brigands, and political instability. In 1368, power finally passed to Zhu Yuanzhang, one of the leaders of the Red Turban secret society, who had struggled for years against Yuan warlords of southern China. "Proclaim yourself emperor slowly," one of his counselors suggested and Zhu consolidated his gains carefully from his capital at Nanjing. This new dynasty would be known by the epithet of Ming, or "brilliant."

The Ming dynasty (1368-1644) truly lived up to the dimensions of this epithet. In the year 1600, the Chinese empire was the largest and most sophisticated of all unified realms in the world. Its population of over 120 million was greater than the population of all European countries combined. The era of the Ming and its successor dynasty, the Qing (1644-1911), represent the longest period of good government in Chinese history. While rulers in Europe, India, Japan, and the Ottoman Empire were struggling to develop stable models of imperial rule, China retained its traditions of systematic bureaucracy, law, and provincial administration that had existed for over a millennium. Historians have described this as the "perfected" late imperial system of government, since it represented an improved continuation of the structure that had been so successful during the Han, Tang, and Song dynasties. Ming emperors generally maintained a Confucian approach to progressive government. The civil service examinations became ever more intense and competitive, since the rewards of public service were so great. These administrators were generally produced from a strong gentry class of urban, well-educated individuals.

At the center of power was the emperor, whose position became even more despotic and was maintained by a sophisticated secret police and brutal prison system. The third Ming emperor moved his capital from Nanjing to Beijing and constructed an elaborate Forbidden Palace. The entire complex redefined the majesty of the emperor as absolute ruler. The palace had over 6,000 cooks who served 10,000 persons daily and included an enormous harem with a staff of about 70,000 eunuchs. This isolation and reverence of the emperor promoted the political unity of China, but later contributed to the decline of the regime during the Qing as emperors were increasingly isolated from political and social realities.

Like other Chinese dynasties, the Ming and Qing passed through what historians refer to as a "dynastic cycle." At the outset, the dynasties consolidated political authority and began expansive periods characterized by energetic reforms and ambitious projects. As the dynasties aged, political and social stability fell prey to corruption, popular discontent, eventual decline and failure. In foreign affairs, the beginning of the cycle saw an expansive energy only to decline into an isolationist stance. For all of the impressive Chinese political stability and wonderful artistic contributions, the dynamic momentum of civilization resided in Europe during these centuries. The western Renaissance, Reformation, scientific revolution, Enlightenment, democratic and industrial revolutions all happened concurrent to Ming and Qing rule. The West had accelerated while China was withdrawing from the world stage, becoming increasingly conservative and isolationist.

The Voyages of Zheng He

ZHANG TINGYU

Perhaps the most ambitious decision of the early Ming dynasty was the promotion of Zheng He's Seven Voyages to the Western Ocean. In some of the largest and best constructed ships in the world at the time, the eunuch, Zheng He (ca. 1373-1435), sailed to such remote locations as the Persian Gulf, the Red Sea, and the eastern coast of Africa. He returned with dozens of foreign kings, who in turn, paid tribute to the Chinese emperor. When Zheng He set out on his last voyage in 1430, the fortunes of the Ming had already started to decline, and such ambitious and expensive voyages could no longer be financed. Still, they demonstrate that world exploration was certainly not an exclusive European or Islamic preserve. Such ventures also flowed from the East to the West. The historian Zhang Tingyu provides the following account of these impressive voyages.

After his accession to the throne, Emperor Yunglo, suspected that his defeated predecessor Xuiti might have escaped from Nanking and be residing somewhere in the South Seas and wanted very much to know his whereabouts. Besides, he wished to glorify Chinese arms in the remote regions and show off the wealth and power of the Central Kingdom. It was this combination of motives that prompted him to launch Zheng He's voyages.

In the sixth month of 1405, Zheng He and his deputy Wang Jinghong, as ordered by the emperor, proceeded with their journey to the Western Ocean [areas of South and Southeast Asia]. Well furnished with treasure and accompanied by more than 27,800 officers and men, they sailed in sixty-two giant ships, each of which measured [517 feet] in length and [212 feet] in width. The ships left the Liuchia River [near modern Shanghai] for the sea and then sailed southward to...Champa [Vietnam]. From Champa, the Chinese envoys visited one country after another. They read the imperial decree that demanded the submission of the kingdoms they visited and rewarded generously those rulers who agreed to submit. As for those who chose not obey, force was used to assure their compliance.

In the ninth month of [1407], Zheng He returned to the capital and presented to the emperor tribute-bearing envoys from the kingdoms he had visited. The emperor was greatly pleased and granted titles and financial rewards to all of those who had been presented to him. Zheng He also brought back many prisoners of war, including the captured king of Palembang [Indonesia].

[Palembang's ruler], a Chinese named Chen Zuyi, had been active as a pirate in the South Seas before he was captured by Zheng He. When Zheng He demanded his surrender, he said he would, but in secret he was planning to launch an attack upon Zheng He's ships. Once the perfidy was recognized, Zheng He attacked and won a decisive victory. Chen Zuyi was captured alive and later bought to Beijing. He was executed shortly afterward....

In the eleventh month of [1412], the emperor again ordered Zheng He to proceed to Sumatra. Zheng He arrived at a time when Sekeander, son of a former ruler of that kingdom, was plotting the overthrow of the reigning prince so as to establish himself as the king. Resenting Zheng He for having failed to give him any gold or silk, he ordered his men to attack Chinese troops. Zheng He responded vigorously, defeated his army, and pursued him until, he, together with his family, was captured at Lambri. The Chinese envoy returned to Beijing in the seventh month of [1415], to be welcomed by a pleased emperor who rewarded all the officers and men for their efforts....

Zheng He served three emperors with distinction and conducted seven voyages altogether, [visiting thirty kingdoms].... The amount of treasure he brought to China from these kingdoms was of course enormous, but the expense to China herself was even more staggering. [From 1426-1435], these kingdoms, occasionally, still sent tribute missions to China, but they could not be compared with the tribute missions [from 1403 to 1424] that were not only more sumptuous but also more frequent. By then Zheng He had become too old to undertake any strenuous task. Long after his death, however,

his achievement was still so highly regarded that Chinese generals and admirals, whenever serving abroad, kept mentioning it as a way to impress foreigners. Even laymen spoke of the Seven Voyages...as a most outstanding event of the Ming dynasty.

Consider This:

12) Why did the Chinese emperor decide to sponsor the voyages of Zheng He? Where did Zheng Travel and which of his actions were particularly impressive? What do his voyages say about the strength and vision of the early Ming dynasty?

Gentleman Wang: The Noble Merchant

DAOKUN

The following portrait of a revered Chinese merchant reveals much about business practices during the Ming. Note especially the qualities of character that were esteemed in China.

In 1556, Mr. Wang, who was ninety years old at the time, was given the highest prefectural title by imperial decree and from that time on has been treated with the courtesies due an elder. As the histories testify, in ancient times emperors often honored venerable old men so as to receive the benefit of their constant advice. Even at his great age, Mr. Wang is a man of the highest integrity; therefore I now extol his deeds in order to show my respect for virtuous old men....

Mr. Wang lives in Shanghai. Being open and confident he has attracted the respect of many capable and prosperous people who compete to attach themselves to him. At first, Mr. Wang's capital was no greater than the average person's. Later, as he grew more prosperous every day, the number of his associates also steadily increased. To accommodate his apprentices, Mr. Wang built buildings with doors on four sides. Whenever customers came, they could be taken care of from all four directions; thus, no one ever had to wait very long.

Mr. Wang set up the following guidelines for his associates: do not let anyone who lives in another county control the banking; when lending money, never harass law-abiding people unnecessarily or give them less than they need; charge low interest on loans; do not aim at high profit and do not ask for daily interest. These principles led customers to throng to him, even ones from neighboring towns and provinces. Within a short time, Mr. Wang accumulated great wealth; in fact, of all the rich people in that area he became the richest.

Mr. Wang liked to help people and to give assistance to the poor. If anyone among his kinsmen could not afford a funeral for his parents, Mr. Wang would always buy some land and build a tomb for him. As soon as he heard someone could not make ends meet, he would buy land to rent to him. Whenever he was out traveling and met some unburied spirit, he would bid his servants bury it and present some offerings....

When Mr. Wang is at home he is always in high spirits. He likes to make friends with the chivalrous youths. In his later years he has become particularly fond of chess, often staying up all night until he either wins or loses a game. The youths say that Mr. Wang is no ordinary person, that he must have received instruction from Heaven.

Now Mr. Wang is almost one hundred years old. He has at least thirty sons and grandsons living at home with him. It is said, "One who seeks perfection will attain it." This describes Mr. Wang perfectly.

Consider This:

13) What were some of the reasons that the merchant Wang prospered in his business practices? Would you say that such principles are still important in contemporary society? How does this account demonstrate the Confucian virtue of *jen* (humanity) and how does it reflect the Chinese respect for the elderly?

The Coming of the West and the "Portuguese Problem"

Portuguese explorers were often the first Europeans to encounter the peoples and develop the markets of India and Africa. When Portuguese traders arrived at Canton, China in the early 1500s, the Chinese believed that they had come to pay tribute and "partake of a superior civilization." The Chinese soon discovered that the Portuguese sought to exploit the region with actions that bordered on piracy. Still, the Portuguese brought with them goods and spices that were greatly desired. And although the Chinese government imposed severe restrictions on foreigners, other coastal Chinese were willing to trade with the "red-haired barbarians." The following accounts from two officials testify to the ambivalence of Chinese policy. The "Portuguese Problem" remained a source of irritation for the Chinese that was exacerbated in the early seventeenth century by the arrival of the Dutch, who were themselves aggressive traders.

Zhang Tingyu: Censor Ho Ao also presented a memo [to the emperor] in connection with the Fu-lang-chi [Portuguese] problem. "The people of Portugal are as brutal as they are treacherous, and their military equipment is far superior to that of other foreigners," said the memorialist. "Sometimes, borne on large ships, they suddenly burst into the capital of Canton: the sound of their cannons could be heard far and wide. The Portuguese who remained at Huaiyuan I violated the law by communicating with the Chinese, and those who went to the capital [Beijing] were arrogant enough to show off their so-called talents. If we allow them to travel freely and trade, strife is bound to break out, and the mischief they can start among the people in the south will never come to an end. The ancestors of our dynasty specified the years when tribute missions were allowed and provided us with guides to keep our national defense strong. As a result, the visits of tribute missions from foreign countries have been infrequent. Lately,...we have allowed these Portugese people to come and trade in any year they choose. The result is that foreign ships keep sailing into our rivers and seas, and foreigners themselves live side by side with the Chinese in our towns and cities. As we continue to relax our defense measures, foreigners have become more and more familiar with our waterways. This is the reason why the Portuguese were able to make intrusions into our territory without our advance knowledge. I

accordingly suggest that all foreign ships currently anchored in our bays and harbors should be expelled at once and that all foreigners who live in China without permission should be deported immediately. Clandestine communication with foreigners should be prohibited, and our defense should be further strengthened. Only in this way can our coastal areas again enjoy peace and security."... The emperor replied: "Let this be done."

Huo Ruxia: What then should we do? There are three measures we can take, each exclusive of the others. The best measure would be to govern them in the same manner as we govern our own people: to convert the territory they have occupied into a subprefecture and to place them under the jurisdictional control of duly appointed government officials. The next best measure would be to expel them and make sure that they never come back again. The worst measure would be to cut off their food supply, which would force them to revolt, and then use armed forces to exterminate them...

Some people may say that once these barbarians are expelled from China, there will be no further disturbances on our frontier and our people will be much better off. How, they may ask, can expulsion be regarded as the second best course? I reply that to have confidence in the barbarians' natural goodness for our own defense is reflective of the greatness of the Son of Heaven, that to welcome all barbarians to partake of our civilization is indicative of the benign nature of the Celestial King, and that to provide food for our enemy so as to pacify the frontier betokens the farsightedness of a powerful nation.... In short, to construct cities for them and to govern them with Chinese officials in accordance with the Chinese law will be the best policy to follow. It is best because it is a policy of kindness by which peace can be secured without great effort.

Consider This:

14) What was the "Portuguese Problem" and what options did the Chinese government explore in order to control their actions? Compare Portuguese actions in China with those in India and Africa. What was the Portuguese mode of operation?

The Jesuits

ZHANG TINGYU

Not all Europeans who ventured to China were out simply for financial gain. In addition to traders, the Catholic church, smarting from European set-backs during the Protestant Reformation, sought new converts in the East. The Jesuit order, founded about 1540 by Ignatius Loyola, provided most of these missionaries. One of the most respected Jesuits, Matteo Ricci, arrived in China in 1583 and stayed there until his death in 1610. Ricci became fluent in Chinese and so impressed the emperor with his knowledge that he was made a court mathematician and astronomer. His journals were published in 1615 and offer us a detailed glimpse into the life of Ming China. The first selection by the court historian Zhang Tingyu describes the influence of Matteo Ricci from a Chinese perspective. This is followed by an excerpt from Ricci's own journals about the extraordinary gifts of China.

Italy is located in the Great Western Ocean and had no relationship with China in ancient time. During the Wanli period [1573-1619], an Italian named Li Mazou [Matteo Ricci] came to the capital [Beijing] and presented an atlas of the world. "There are five continents in the world," he said. "The first continent is Asia, consisting of more than one hundred countries, including China. The second continent is Europe, consisting of more than seventy countries, including Italy. The third continent, Africa, also has more than one hundred countries. The fourth continent, America, is even larger and has two constituent parts, North and South America. The last or fifth continent is Australia. These five continents are all the land in this world." His words were so vague and incoherent that they could not be verified in any of the books then in existence. But the fact that people from these remote lands did roam about in China seemed to indicate that there was some truth in his remarks.

All these people came from European counties and believed in a religion called Roman Catholicism. Jesus, the man whom they worshiped, was born...in a country called Judea. Fifteen hundred eighty-one years later, in [1581], Li Mazou sailed across the ocean and arrived a Macao off Canton. With his arrival in China came his religion....

The tribute this man has presented consists of the images of a Heavenly Lord and His Mother [Mary, Mother of Jesus], a tribute that is highly irregular. He has also brought with him "bones of the immortals [relics]." The term "bones of the immortal" is self-contradictory since a true immortal can fly by himself without any bones....

Later, the emperor, pleased that this man had come such a long way to visit China, granted him living quarters and a food allowance, plus numerous gifts. All the ministers at court thought highly of the man and associated with him. Li Mazou was so happy with his new home that he decided to stay until the end of his life. He died in [1610] and was buried in the western suburb of Beijing....

The people who came from the Great Western Ocean [Jesuit missionaries] were mostly intelligent and highly knowledgeable. They were only interested in spreading their religion and did not care for fame or wealth. The books they wrote dealt with topics which the Chinese rarely mentioned, and those who loved different and strange things were anxious to learn from them.... As a result , this religion, called Roman Catholicism, suddenly flourished in China.

The Life of China

MATTEO RICCI

This country is so thoroughly covered by an intersecting network of rivers and canals that it is possible to travel almost anywhere by water. Hence, an almost incredible number of boats of every variety pass hither and thither. Indeed, there are so many of them that one of the writers of our day does not hesitate to affirm that there are as many people living on the water as there are dwellers on land. This may sound like an exaggeration and yet it all but expresses the truth, as it would seem, if one were to travel here only by water. In my opinion, it might be said with greater truth and without fear of exaggeration, that there are as many boats in this kingdom as can be counted up in all the rest of the world....

The ordinary tableware of the Chinese is clay pottery. It is not quite clear to me why it is called porcelain in the West. There is nothing like it in European pottery either from the standpoint of the material itself or its thin and fragile construction. The finest specimens of porcelain are made from clay found in the province of Kiam, and these are shipped not only to every part of China, but even to the remotest corners of Europe where they are highly prized by those who appreciate elegance at their banquets rather than pompous display. This porcelain, too, will bear the heat of hot foods without cracking and, what is more to be wondered at, if it is broken and sewed with a brass wire, it will hold liquids without any leakage....

Two or three things are entirely unknown to Europeans of which I must give a brief account. First, there is a certain bush from the leaves of which is decocted that celebrated drink, known to the Chinese, the Japanese, and to their neighbors as tea. Its use cannot be of long duration among the Chinese, as no ideography in their old books designates this particular drink and their writing

characters are all ancient. Indeed, it might be that this same plant can be found in our own fields. Here they gather its leaves in the springtime and place them in a shady place to dry, and from the dried leaves they brew a drink which they use at meals and which is served to friends when they come to visit. On such occasions, it is served continually as long as they remain together engaged in conversation. This beverage is sipped rather than drunk and it is always taken hot. It is no unpleasant to the taste, being somewhat bitter, and it is usually considered to be wholesome even if taken frequently....

Finally we should say something about the saltpeter, which is quite plentiful but which is not used extensively in the preparation of gunpowder, because the Chinese are not expert in the use of guns and artillery and make but little use of these in warfare. Saltpeter, however, is used in lavish quantities in making fireworks for display at public games and on festival days. The Chinese take great pleasure in such exhibitions and make them the chief attraction of all their festivities. Their skill in the manufacture of fireworks is really extraordinary, and there is scarcely anything which they cannot cleverly imitate with them. They are especially adept in reproducing battles and in making rotating spheres of fire, fiery trees, fruit, and the like, and they seem to have no regard for expense where fireworks are concerned. When I was in Nanjing, I witnessed a pyrotechnic display for the celebration of the first month of the year, which is their great festival, and on this occasion, I calculated that thy consumed enough powder to carry on a sizable war for a number of years....

The art of printing was practiced in China at a date somewhat earlier than that assigned to the beginning of printing in Europe, which was about 1405. It is quite certain that the Chinese knew the art of printing at least five centuries ago, and some of them assert that printing was known to their people before the beginning of the Christian era, about 50 B.C....

Their method of making printed books is quite ingenious. The text is written in ink, with a brush made of very fine hair, on a sheet of paper which is inverted and pasted on a wooden tablet. When the paper has become thoroughly dry, its surface is scraped off quickly and with great skill, until nothing but a fine tissue bearing the characters remains on the wooden tablet. Then, with a steel graver, the workman cuts away the surface following the outlines of the characters until these alone stand out in low relief. From such a block a skilled printer can make copies with incredible speed, turning out as many as fifteen hundred copies in a single day. Chinese printers are so skilled in engraving these blocks, that no more time is consumed in making one of them than would be required by one of our printers in setting up a form of type and making the necessary corrections....

The simplicity of Chinese printing is what accounts for the exceedingly large number of books in circulation here and the ridiculously low prices at which they are sold. Such facts as these would scarcely be believed by one who had not witnessed them....

Consider This:

15) Who was Matteo Ricci and why was he respected by the Chinese? What does the account by Zhang Tingyu reveal about the Chinese view of the world about 1600? In Matteo Ricci's journal, what specifically does he advise about the Chinese and their way of life?

The Grand Eunuch Wei and Ming Decline

ZHANG TINGYU

The Ming dynasty saw the expansion of the autocratic power of the Chinese emperor. As Sons of Heaven, they were entitled to the best amenities in life, from extraordinary personal power to the pleasures of food and sex. Their harems numbered in the thousands and were composed of women chosen for their beauty and charm. How best to oversee the purity of such valuable amenities? The Chinese solution was to castrate low-born males during childhood and train them to manage the "interior bureaucracy" of the palace, which, of course, included the harem. Powerful and competent emperors controlled the influence of their most devoted eunuchs, but weak emperors, as in the Roman Empire, fell prey to the machinations of ambitious servants. One of the most legendary of these eunuchs was Wei Zhongxian. His power was unrivaled and contributed to political instability and the decline of the Ming.

Selected as a palace eunuch [under the Emperor Wanli (1573-1619)], Wei Zhongxian moved quickly to ingratiate himself with those who could help his cause. An excellent cook, he was particularly patronized by Princess Wang, mother of the crown prince designate, later known as Emperor Ming Xizun. Subsequently he became a lover to the prince's wet nurse name Ke, who had abandoned an earlier lover on his behalf. As later events proved, this alliance between a eunuch and a wet nurse, based upon a relationship of illicit love, formed the basis of Wei Zhongxian's emergence to power.

Within a month after Ming Xizun's accession to the throne, wet nurse Ke was titled Madame Fengsheng and eunuch Wei received three simultaneous appointments, including the appointment as administrator of rites. Normally only a man of great learning could be privileged to occupy that post; eunuch Wei acquired that post only because of Ke's insistence. Meanwhile the close relatives of both, including an elder brother of the eunuch, were promoted to lucrative positions and titled accordingly. The increasing influence of Ke alarmed many members of the censorate who, noting the forthcoming royal marriage, maintained that the emperor had no more need of his wet nurse and that she, indeed, should be ousted from the palace. The emperor, in reply, stated that he could no more dispense with

the service of his wet nurse than he could with that of his own mother. In view of the love and protection that the wet nurse had provided for him when he was a child, he, the emperor, could not but be eternally grateful.

As long as Ke's influence over the emperor continued, Wei Zhongxian could do whatever he pleased with his rivals or enemies inside the palace. All of them, one after another were ousted from positions of power and influence, including Ke's former lover previously mentioned. Having thus secured his own position inside the palace, Wei Zhongxian received permission from the emperor to train the eunuchs under his control in the use of military weapons and other martial arts. To keep the emperor busy, he led the young man to a variety of dissipations, such as sex, music, hunting, and gambling....

So far the power of eunuch Wei was confined to the palace. To explain its extension to the imperial government and eventually the country as a whole, we have to review the development of events toward the end of the Wanli period. Later in his life Emperor Wanli increasingly lost interest in the management of state affairs and seldom bothered to read the memorials that had been presented to him. As he gradually moved away from political activities, factions began to develop among his ministers, each of whom resorted to the expression of radical ideas to gain attention and influence....

Those who opposed the Grand Eunuch were dismissed from their posts, while those who supported him were either appointed to new positions or promoted to greater responsibility. To impress others with his own importance, the Grand Eunuch increased his personal retainers to ten thousand and was always escorted by armed guards, whether inside or outside the palace. Meanwhile his palace ally Ke was doing her utmost to make sure that the royal weakling could not produce a legitimate heir. Concubine Chang was executed in secret when it was learned that she had become

pregnant; when the empress was also found to have become pregnant, Ke made sure that a miscarriage would occur. Thus the boy emperor, despite the size of his harem, was never able to produce an heir....

The Grand Eunuch [decided] to purge or physically eliminate all of his opponents.... By 1626, not only the officials in the imperial government, but also those on the local level had become devoted followers of the Grand Eunuch. In the sixth month of that year Ban Ruzhen, Governor of Zhekiang [province], petitioned for the erection of a living shrine in honor of the Grand Eunuch.... Before long, living shrines in honor of the Grand Eunuch mushroomed all over the empire. From every corner of the empire came eulogies, the writers of which competed with one another in extolling the Grand Eunuch's virtues. Those who disagree openly were arrested on trumped-up charges and punished accordingly. A political machine was thus established, which functioned effectively, though ruthlessly, throughout the empire. Its top echelon consisted of a military as well as a civilian group....

Great though it was, the power of the Grand Eunuch Wei fell as precipitously as it had risen. In 1627, emperor Ming Xizun died and was succeeded by Prince Xing who, after accession, was known as Emperor Ming Zhongxian [1627-1644]. When serving as a crown prince, Zhongxian detested Grand Eunuch Wei for his evil ways but was careful enough not to offend him until he, upon becoming an emperor, could do something about his misgivings. Indictments against the Grand Eunuch soon appeared on [the Emperors's] desk.... The Emperor summoned the Grand Eunuch to his presence and asked one of the officials to read the indictment aloud. Realizing that the walls had finally closed in on him, the Grand Eunuch offered heavy bribes to...the Emperor's own eunuch and confidant and the Grand Eunuch's one-time gambling partner, hoping to ease the pressure. The Emperor learned about the bribe and reprimanded [his eunuch] for accepting it. In 1627, the Grand Eunuch was exiled to Fengyang.

Consider This:

16) According to the account of Zhang Tingyu, how did the Grand Eunuch Wei achieve such overwhelming influence over the emperor? How did he exploit his power and how did this contribute to the instability of the dynasty? What was Wei's ultimate fate?

A Plan for the Prince

ZHANG TINGYU

The historian Zhang Tingyu (1610-1675), who contributed many of the selections in this section, was the son of a high Ming official. His father died in prison at the hands of powerful eunuchs. At age eighteen, after the fall of the Grand Eunuch Wei, he avenged his father's death by bringing to justice those who were responsible. Upon the collapse of the Ming dynasty in 1644, he led unsuccessful guerilla operations against the new Manchu dynasty and then settled down at age fifty-two to write the history of the Ming. Perhaps his most impressive work, A Plan for the Prince*, analyzes political and economic weaknesses of seventeenth century China.*

In many ways, Zhang's life parallels another impressive political observer, the Florentine Niccolò Machiavelli (1469-1527). After serving the republic of Florence, Machiavelli was imprisoned by the restored Medici family in 1512, tortured, and forced from power. He returned and wrote a short political manual entitled The Prince *(1519), offering advice on gaining and maintaining power. In the following selection, note carefully Zhang Tingyu's Confucian emphasis on the importance of character in good government, both in the position of the Prince and in his ministers. Machiavelli would reject such notions, arguing that politics was an amoral game of survival.*

In ancient times, the people were considered hosts and the prince was the guest. All of his life the prince spent working for the sake of the people. Now the prince is host and the people are guests. Because of the prince, people can find peace and happiness nowhere. In order to achieve his ends, people must be harmed and killed and their families broken up–all for the aggrandizement of one man's fortune. Without feeling the least pity for mankind, the prince says: "I want only to establish this estate for the sake of my descendants." Yet when he has established it, the prince still wrings every drop of blood and marrow from the people and takes away their sons and daughters to serve his

excessive pleasures. It seems entirely proper to him. It is, he says, the interest on his estate. Thus the greatest enemy of mankind is the prince and nothing but the prince.

If there had been no rulers, each man would have lived for himself and secured what was to his own benefit. Could it be that the institution of rulership was meant to work out like this? In ancient times men loved their prince, thought of him as a father, likened him to God; and truly this was no more than just. Now men hate their prince, think of him as a mortal foe, call him an "outcast"....

It is not easy to make plain the function of the prince, but any fool can see that a brief moment of excessive pleasure is not worth an eternity of sorrows.

The reason for ministership lies in the fact that the world is too big for one man to govern and that it is necessary to share the work with others. Therefore, when I come forth to serve, it is for the whole world and not for the prince; it is for all men and not for one family....

But those who act as ministers today do not understand this concept. They say that a minister is created for the prince, that he rules only because the prince shares part of the world with him and delegates to him some leadership over the people. They look upon the world and its people as personal property in the prince's pouch....

Whether there is peace or disorder in the world does not depend on the rise and fall of dynasties, but upon the happiness or distress of the people....

If a minister ignores the plight of the people, then even if he succeeds in assisting his prince's rise to power or follows him to final ruin, it still can never be said that he has followed the [True] Way of the Minister.... Alas, the insolent princes of later times indulge themselves [in the same way] and do not tend to the business of the world an its people. From among the men of the country they seek out only such as will be servile errand-boys. And if from the country those alone respond who are of

the servile errand-boy type, then when they are protected from cold and hunger for a while, they feel eternally grateful for his majesty's kindness. Such men will not care whether they are treated by the prince with due respect, and will think it no more than proper to be relegated to a servant's status....

The terms "prince" and "minister" derive their significance from service to mankind. If I have no sense of duty to mankind I am an alien to the prince. If I come to serve him without any consideration for the welfare of mankind, then I am merely the prince's menial servant. If, on the other hand, I have the people's interest at heart, then I am the prince's mentor and colleague. Only then may I really be called a minister.

Consider This:

17) According to Zhang Tingyu, what is the function of the Chinese emperor or "Prince" as he calls him? Why do people hate their Prince? What are the responsibilities of the ministers of the Prince? The Italian political philosopher, Niccolò Machiavelli, argued that a Prince must always be wary of advisors who seek only his approval and "yes men" who offer nothing but flattery. Would Zhang Tingyu have agreed?

The Establishment of Tokugawa Japan

*The medieval period in Japan, from the twelfth to the sixteenth centuries, was a complex time of incessant change. Although the emperor reigned over Japan, the administrative and military affairs of the state were controlled by the shōgun, chosen for his preeminent authority and influence among the great lords (*daimyō*) of the realm. The Ashikaga Shogunate that had ruled Japan since the fourteenth century from its capital in Kyoto had never really been able to control the political independence of regional* daimyō*. By the first half of the sixteenth century, the worst period of disorder, there was virtually no unified leadership in Japan and the country degenerated into over sixty independent domains, each ruled by local lords with aspirations of greatness. There began a contest of elimination to determine the political future of the state, a contest remarkable for its bloody ferocity. Out of this chaos emerged three generals whose vigor, ambition and ruthlessness led to the reorganization of Japan and the establishment of a unified nation.*

One of the great figures in the process of political unification was Oda Nobunaga (1534-1582). Born into a rather obscure family, his ambition was "to bring the entire country under one sword," a motto inscribed on his personal seal. Nobunaga, determined and tenacious in the pursuit of his goals, showed amazing flexibility in his methods. His audacity on the battle field won him the support of many local lords and he eliminated rivals with ruthless treachery.

Perhaps the most illustrative example of his vindictiveness was the destruction of the famous Buddhist stronghold on Mount Hiei. Contending Buddhist sects had played a crucial role in the struggle for power over the Ashikaga Shogunate. Although many of these Buddhist religious communities were peaceful and set themselves apart from the political fray, others supplied "warrior-monks," who fought as mercenaries. Nobunaga harbored a deep resentment for Buddhism and considered it a threat to political stability. The fate of the monastery on Mount Hiei demonstrates the ruthlessness that made Nobunaga both feared and successful.

The Slaughter on Mount Hiei (1571)

On September 11, [1571], Nobunaga encamped...in Seta and ordered his principal retainers to set fire to and to destroy all temples, halls, and quarters on Mount Hiei and to annihilate all monks and inmates. Devoid of compassion, he relentlessly commanded his men to hasten with the destruction. Although vassals close to him, armed and confounded, admonished him not to go ahead with the order, Nobunaga's indignation increased and he could not be restrained. Thus, all helplessly acceded to his order. Then [Sakuma] Nobumori and [Sekian] of Higo came forward...to rebuke Nobunaga. They told him that this mountain center, since its founding...had been the guardian of the imperial palace for

eight hundred years, and that its complaints to the Throne–even the most audacious–had not gone unheeded. "Although it is said that ours is a degenerate age," they continued, "such an act as the destruction of the center is an unprecedented, unheard-of act." In the face of this strong rebuke, Nobunaga explained that he was not entirely insensitive to the warning, but he requested that they listen calmly to what he had to say. He said, "I am not the destroyer of this monastery. The destroyer of the monastery is the monastery itself. As you know, I am one who has not known a moment of peace. I have risked my life. I have devoted myself to hard work and to a life of denial of my personal desires. I have given myself to the hardships of warrior life in order that I might restrain the turbulence within the land, check the decline of imperial prestige and restore it, improve the prevailing manners and customs, and perpetuate the benefits of government and religion. But last year, when Noda and Fukushima of Settsu Province [enemies] were about to be subdued and their strongholds about to fall, Asakura and Asai seized the opportunity of my absence to invade Shiga in this province at the head of several tens of thousands of mounted troops. Thus, I was compelled to return here and to expel them from Sakamoto. The following day I drove the rebels to the hilltop of Tsubogusa. The deep snows retarded their flight and they were about to be slain by our men when the monastic inmates of Mt. Hiei came to their assistance. You were sent to dissuade and to reason with the monks, but they would not listen. Whereupon, I sent another envoy–Inaba–to inform them that if they persisted in their decision, all buildings without exception, including the central cathedral and the Shrine of the Mountain King [a Shinto deity], would be burned and destroyed, and all inmates–clergy and otherwise–would be decapitated. Still they would not yield. I do not speak falsehoods. It is they who obstruct the maintenance of law and order in the country. Those who would help rebels are themselves traitors to the country. If, moreover, they are not destroyed now, they will again become a peril to the

nation. Therefore not a single life should be spared." So convincing was his reasoning that even Sekian, succumbed to his arguments without a word of protest...

Everything, everywhere, from the central cathedral to the twenty-one shrines of the Mountain King, the bell tower and the library, were burned to the ground. Moreover, the holy scriptures...and the records of the imperial capital under generations of emperors were destroyed at once. Great scholars, men of rare talents, aged priests and young boys–still with their innocent, delicate features–were either beheaded or taken captive....

The roar of the huge burning monastery, magnified by the cries of countless numbers of the old and the young, sounded and resounded to the ends of heaven and earth. The noise was at once deafening and pathetic... Thus, it may be said that the destruction of the mountain center was its own doing and not that of Nobunaga.

The Introduction of Firearms

NAMPO BUNSHI

Nobunaga's hostility to tradition and convention left him receptive to new ideas and helped him adapt successfully to changing circumstances. His hostility toward Buddhism was contrasted with his cordiality toward Christian missionaries. He was particularly generous with Portuguese Jesuits and was receptive to European technology.

Firearms were introduced to Japan in 1542 by Portuguese adventurers and immediately stirred controversy. Many soldiers despised the new matchlock guns called arquebuses *as weapons for cowards. In Japan, the sword of the samurai had over the centuries become a quasi-religious symbol of fear and class dominance. But Nobunaga and commanders like him quickly saw the advantage of pressing peasants into military service and training them in new tactics. The gun invested the common soldier with power and purpose that Nobunaga used to advantage. In 1575, at the Battle of Nagashino, a small force of Nobunaga's musketeers mowed down four waves of samurai horsemen with their disciplined volleys. Cavalry quickly became only a ceremonial fixture. In the following selection dated about 1600, a chronicler describes the introduction of firearms into Japan and the adaptations made by a regional lord named Tokitada.*

There are two leaders among the traders, the one called Murashusa, and the other Christian Mota. In their hands they carried something two or three feet long, straight on the outside with a passage inside, and made of a heavy substance. The inner passage runs through it although it is closed at the end. At its side there is an aperture which is the passageway for fire. Its shape defies comparison with anything I know. To use it, fill with powder and small lead pellets. Set up a small white target on a bank. Grip the object in you hand, compose your body, and closing one eye, apply fire to the aperture. Then the pellet hits the target squarely. The explosion is like lightning and the report like thunder. Bystanders must cover their ears.... This thing with one blow can smash a mountain of silver and a wall of iron....

Lord Tokitada saw it and though it was the wonder of wonders. He did not know its name at first nor the details of its use. Then someone called it "iron-arms".... Thus, one day Tokitada spoke to the two alien leaders through an interpreter: "Incapable though I am, I should like to learn about it."...

Disregarding the high price of the arms, Tokitada purchased from the aliens two pieces of the firearms for his family treasure. As for the art of grinding, sifting, and mixing of the powder, Tokitada let his retainer, Shinokawa Shoshiro, learn it. Tokitada occupied himself, morning and night, and without rest in handling the arms. As a result, he was able to convert the misses of his early experiment into hits–a hundred hits in a hundred attempts....

It is more than sixty years since the introduction of this weapon into our country. There are some gray-haired men who still remember the event clearly. The fact is that Tokitada procured two pieces of the weapon and studied them, and with one volley of the weapon, startled sixty provinces of our country.

Consider This:

18) Why did Nobunaga destroy the Buddhist monastery on Mount Hiei in 1571? What do you learn about the character of Nobunaga through this act? Do you agree that the destruction of this mountain center "was its own doing and not that of Nobunaga"? In his rise to power, Nobunaga profited from his use of firearms. Why was the introduction of firearms to Japan such an important event? How did Japanese society change as a result?

The Sword Collection Edict (1588)

TOYOTOMI HIDEYOSHI

Perhaps the greatest success story in Japanese history belongs to Toyotomi Hideyoshi (1536-1598), who rose from a menial position under Nobunaga to undisputed master of Japan by 1590, eight years after Nobunaga's death. Born into obscurity, homeless and without even a family name, Hideyoshi had the consuming ambition of Nobunaga, but achieved a reputation for magnanimity by using his diplomatic abilities to persuade and compromise. He achieved a settlement with the Buddhist religious communities and strengthened the internal administration of the country. Through a series of ordinances on land reform, he sought to establish a stable tax basis, confirm local autonomy, and reward his loyal retainers. In many ways, Hideyoshi's rule reinforced feudal society, and his financial support of the shogunate in Kyoto maintained social and political stability during a dangerous period. On his death in 1598, he was granted the posthumous Shinto title, Hōkoku, or "Wealth of the Nation."

Hideyoshi's domestic agenda supported an ambitious world vision of controlling all of East Asia. To quell civil disturbances at home, he issued the following sword collection order in 1588. The ensuing "Sword Hunt" deprived the peasants of their weaponry and made fighting once again the exclusive prerogative of an hereditary class. Note how he even supplied a popular and pious motive in justifying the collection of swords; they were to be recast as a great Buddha image.

1. The people of the various provinces are strictly forbidden to have in their possession any swords, short swords, bows, spears, firearms, or other types of arms. The possession of unnecessary implements [of war] makes difficult the collection of taxes and dues and tends to foment uprisings. Needless to say, the perpetrators of improper acts against official agents shall be summarily punished, but in that event the paddy fields and farms of the violators will remain unattended and there will be no yield of crops. Therefore, the heads of provinces, official agents, and deputies are ordered to collect all the weapons mentioned above and turn them over to the government.

2. Swords and short swords thus collected will not be wasted. They shall be used as nails and bolts in the construction of the Great Image of Buddha. This will benefit the people not only in this life, but also in the life hereafter.

3. If the people are in possession of agricultural implements only and devote themselves exclusively to agriculture, they and their descendants will prosper. Sincere concern for the well-being of the people is the motive for the issuance of this order, which is fundamental for the peace and security of the country and the happiness of the people....

All implements mentioned above shall be collected and submitted forthwith.

Hideyoshi

Seventh Month, 8th day

Laws Governing Military Households (1598)

HIDETADA

After the death of Hideyoshi in 1598, Tokugawa Ieyasu (1542-1616), a protege of Nobunaga and commander of ability, defeated a powerful coalition of rivals and was appointed shogun in 1603. Less impetuous than Nobunaga and less colorful than Hideyoshi, Ieyasu proved himself to be an astute politician with the vision and abilities to mold a lasting peace. From 1616 to 1868, Japan remained prosperous and at peace largely through the stable influence of Ieyasu and his successors.

The first selection is an edict promulgated in 1615, a year before Ieyasu's death by his immediate successor as shōgun, Hidetada. The object of this law was to insure peace and order among feudal domains. It also served as a moral guide for the feudal nobility with an emphasis on loyalty, martial valor, and personal honor. The last selection by Ieyasu's son and eventual successor, Iemitsu, reflects the continued desire to maintain domestic stability by limiting and controlling the foreign influence of priests and commercial interests. Japan became isolated from the world, comfortable in its traditions and domestic stability, protected from the threat of foreign contamination. When Japan awoke in 1853 upon the arrival of the American commander, Matthew Perry, its introduction to the modern world was both traumatic and decisive.

1. The arts of peace and war, including archery and horsemanship, should be pursued single-mindedly. From of old the rule has been to practice "the arts of peace on the left hand, and the arts of war on the right"; both must be mastered. Archery and horsemanship are indispensable to military men. Though arms are called instruments of evil, there are times when they must be resorted to. In peacetime, we should not be oblivious to the danger of war. Should we not, then, prepare ourselves for it?

2. Drinking parties and wanton revelry should be avoided. In the codes that have come down to us this kind of dissipation has been severely proscribed. Sexual indulgence and habitual gambling lead to the downfall of a state.

3. Offenders against the law should not be harbored or hidden in any domain. Law is the basis of social order. Reason may be violated in the name of the law, but law may not be violated in the name of reason. Those who break the law deserve heavy punishment.

4 Great lords (*daimyō*), the lesser lords, and officials should immediately expel from their domains any among their retainers or henchmen who have been charged with treason or murder. Wild and wicked men may become weapons for overturning the state and destroying the people. How can they be allowed to go free?

7. Immediate report should be made of innovations which are being planned or of factional conspiracies being formed in neighboring domains. "Men all incline toward partisanship; few are wise and impartial. There are some who refuse to obey their masters, and others who feud with their neighbors." Why, instead of abiding by the established order, do they wantonly embark upon new schemes?

8. Do not enter into marriage privately [i.e., without notifying the Shogunate authorities].

Marriage follows the principle of harmony between yin and yang, and must not be entered into lightly. In the *Book of Changes* it says, "Marriage should not be contracted out of enmity [against another]. Marriages intended to effect an alliance with enemies [of the state] will turn out badly." The "Peach Blossom" ode in *The Book of Poetry* also says that "When men and women are proper in their relationships and marriage is arranged at the correct time; then throughout the land there will be no loose women." To form an alliance by marriage is the root of treason.

9. Visits of the daimyo to the capital are to be in accordance with regulations. The *Chronicles of Japan* contains a regulation that "Clansmen should not gather together whenever they please, but only when they have to conduct some public business; and also that the number of horsemen serving as an escort in the capital should be limited to twenty...." Daimyō should not be accompanied by a large number of soldiers. Twenty horsemen shall be the maximum escort for daimyō.... On official missions, however, they may be accompanied by an escort proportionate to their rank.

10. Restrictions on the type and quality of dress to be worn should not be transgressed. Lord and vassal, superior and inferior, should observe what is proper to their station in life.

12. The samurai of the various domains shall lead a frugal and simple life. When the rich make a display of their wealth, the poor are humiliated and envious. Nothing engenders corruption so much as this, and therefore it must be strictly curbed.

Closed Country Edit (1635)

TOKUGAWA IEMITSU

1. Japanese ships are strictly forbidden to leave for foreign countries.

2. No Japanese is permitted to go abroad. If there is anyone who attempts to do so secretly, he must be executed. The ship so involved must be impounded and its owner arrested, and the matter must be reported to the higher authority.

3. If any Japanese returns from overseas after residing there, he must be put to death.

4. If there is any place where the teachings of the [Catholic] priests is practiced, the two of you must order a thorough investigation.

5. Any informer revealing the whereabouts of the followers of the priests must be rewarded accordingly. If anyone reveals the whereabouts of a high ranking priest, he must be given one hundred pieces of silver. For those of lower ranks, depending on the deed, the reward must be set accordingly.

7. If there are any Southern Barbarians [Westerners] who propagate the teaching of the priests, or otherwise commit crimes, they may be incarcerated in the prison....

8. All incoming ships must be carefully searched for the followers of the priests.

10. Samurai [military nobility] are not permitted to purchase any goods originating from foreign ships directly from Chinese merchants in Nagasaki.

14. The date of departure homeward of foreign ships shall not be later than the twentieth day of the ninth month. Any ships arriving in Japan later than usual shall depart within fifty days of their arrival. As to the departure of Chinese ships, you may use your discretion to order their departure after the departure of the Portuguese [galleons].

17. Ships arriving in Hirado [an island near Nagasaki] must sell their raw silk at the price set in Nagasaki, and are not permitted to engage in business transactions until after the price is established in Nagasaki.

You are hereby required to act in accordance with the provisions set above. It is so ordered.

Consider This:

19) Analyze the "Sword Collection Edit" of Hideyoshi and Hidetada's laws to govern military households. Why were these domestic plans enforced? Were they necessary? What does this say about Tokugawa rule?

20) Compare Iemitsu's "Closed Country Edict" in 1635. Why was it so important to isolate Japan from the world? How did this isolation affect the nation? What were the benefits and drawbacks from such enforced isolation?

CHRONOLOGY: *East and West: The Interaction of New Worlds*

1230-1255	Reign of Sundiata, who established Mali's imperial power.
1312-1337	Reign of Mansa Musa, the great Keita King of Mali, who established Timbuktu as the leading Muslim intellectual center in sub-Saharan Africa.
1352	Muslim adventurer, Ibn Battuta, explorers West Africa and records his travel throughout the Islamic world from Africa and Persia, to India and southeast Asia.
1368-1644	Ming Dynasty of China.
1394-1468	Reign of Portuguese Prince Henry the Navigator, who organized and sanctioned Portuguese exploration on the coasts of Africa and India.
1478–1492	Florence ruled by Lorenzo d'Medici, called "The Magnificent." Florence at height of political and artistic influence.
1487	Bartholomew Dias opens spice routes to the East.
1492	Columbus' first voyage to the eastern Bahamas in search of a route to India.
1498	Vasco da Gama trades on Malabar coast of India.
1500-1772	Safavid Shi'ite rule in Iran.
1517	Protestant reformer Martin Luther posts Ninety-five Theses on Wittenberg church door in hopes of engaging clerical authorities in debate.
1519–1521	Hernando Cortés lands on the coast of Mexico and brutally defeats Aztec forces.
1520-1566	Reign of Ottoman Caliph Süleyman the Lawgiver.
1526	Afonso I, King of Kongo, writes to Portuguese King Joao III requesting him to condemn slavery.
1531-1533	Francisco Pizarro conquers Incas in Peru.
1543	Portuguese arrive in Japan.
1556-1605	Reign of Akbar the Great of the Mughal dynasty in India.
1558–1603	Reign of Queen Elizabeth of England, last Tudor monarch.

1585	Silver mines of Potosi, Bolivia bring extraordinary wealth to Spain.
1600-1868	Warring States Era in Japan ends (1603) with the establishment of the Tokugawa Shogunate in Edo.
1607	English settlement of Jamestown.
1620	Pilgrims land at Plymouth.
1624	Dutch colony New Netherland founded.
1628-1630	Puritans establish Massachusetts Bay Colony near Boston.
1642-1649	English Civil War and establishment of the Commonwealth.
1643-1715	Reign of French King Louis XIV.
1644-1911	Qing (Manchu) dynasty in China.
1660-1856	Omani state centered in Zanzibar dominates East Africa and takes Mozambique from Portuguese control in 1698.
1699	British East India Company arrives in China.

SOURCE CITATIONS

"Logbook of the First Voyage" is from *The Four Voyages of Christopher Columbus*, trans. J. M. Cohen (Baltimore, Md., and Harmondsworth, Middlesex: Penguin Books, 1969), pp. 37–38, 43, 51–53. Copyright © J. M. Cohen, 1969. Reprinted by permission.

"The 'New World'" is from R. H. Major, ed., *Select Letters of Christopher Columbus* (London: The Hakluyt Society, 1847), pp. 5–9.

"The Aztec Encounter" is from Bernardino de Sahagún, *The Conquest of New Spain*, trans. Howard F. Cline (Salt Lake City: University of Utah Press, 1989), pp. 34–35. Copyright © 1989 University of Utah Press. Reprinted by permission. Editor's Note: the spelling of Montezuma has been standardized throughout this section.

"Montezuma" is from Hernando Cortés, *Letters from Mexico*, trans. and ed. A. R. Pagden, (New York: Grossman Publishers, 1971), pp. 84–86. Copyright © 1971 by A. R. Pagden. Reprinted by permission.

"Human Sacrifice" is from Hernando Cortés, *Letters from Mexico*, trans. and ed. A. R. Pagden (New York: Grossman Publishers, 1971), pp. 35–36. Copyright © 1971 by A. R. Pagden. Reprinted by permission.

"The Destruction of Tenochtitlán" is from Bernardino de Sahagún, *The Conquest of New Spain*, trans. Howard F. Cline (Salt Lake City: University of Utah Press, 1989), pp. 76–78. Copyright © 1989 University of Utah Press. Reprinted by permission.

"'We Could No Longer Endure the Stench of Dead Bodies'" is from Hernando Cortés, *Letters from Mexico*, trans. and ed. A. R. Pagden (New York: Grossman Publishers, 1971), pp. 261–262. Copyright © 1971 by A. R. Pagden. Reprinted by permission.

"The Devastation of Smallpox" is from Bernardino de Sahagún, *The Conquest of New Spain*, trans. Howard F. Cline (Salt Lake City: University of Utah Press, 1989), p. 103. Copyright © 1989 University of Utah Press. Reprinted by permission.

"The Extraction of Mercury" is from Antonio Vasquez de Espinosa, *Compendium and Description of the West Indies* (Washington D.C.: Smithsonian Institution, 1942), pp. 621-625.

"The Silver Mines of Potosi" is from Antonio Vasquez de Espinosa, *Compendium and Description of the West Indies* (Washington D.C.: Smithsonian Institution, 1942), pp. 631-634.

"The Barbarians of the New World" is from Charles Gibson, editor and translator, *The Spanish Tradition in America* (Columbia, SC: University of South Carolina Press, 1968), pp. 116-120. Copyright © 1968 by Charles Gibson. Reprinted by permission.

"'A Natural Inclination to Submit to a Higher Authority'" is from Sir Frederick Dealtry Lugard, *The Rise of Our East African Empire*, vol. 1 (London: William Blackwood and Sons, 1893), pp. 380–382.

"The 'Black Legend' of Spain" is from Bartolomé de Las Casas, *A Short Account of the Destruction of the Indies*, trans. and ed. Nigel Griffin (New York and Harmondsworth, Middlesex: Penguin Books, 1967), pp. 14–15. Copyright © Nigel Griffin, 1992. Reprinted by permission.

"The Victory of Sundiata" is from D. T. Niane, ed., and G. D. Pickett, trans., *Sundiata: An Epic of Old Mali* (London: Longman Group, Ltd., 1965), pp. 1; 41-42; 49-50. Copyright © 1965 by the Longman Group. Reprinted by permission.

"The Kingdom of Mali" is from H.A.R. Gibb, trans., *Travels of Ibn Battuta in Asia and Africa* (London: Routledge Kegan & Paul, 1927), p. 52.

"The Women of Mali" is from H.A.R. Gibb, trans., *Travels of Ibn Battuta in Asia and Africa* (London: Routledge Kegan & Paul, 1927), pp. 56-58.

"The East Coast of Africa" is from *The Book of Duarte Barbosa: An Account of the Countries Bordering the Indian Ocean*, 2 vols. (London: Hakluyt Society, 1918, 1921).

"Our Kingdom Is Being Lost" is from Basil Davidson, trans., *The African Past* (London: Curtis Brown ltd., 1964), pp. 191-193. Reprinted by permission of Curtis Brown, Ltd., London. Copyright © 1964 by Basil Davidson.

"Cut Off Their Ears, Hands and Noses!" is from H.E.J. Stanley, ed., *The Three Voyages of Vasco de Gama* (London: The Hakluyt Society, 1869), pp. 328-332.

"The Prospects of Christian Conversion" is from Henry James Coleridge, ed., *The Life and Letters of St. Francis Xavier*, 2nd edition (London: Burns and Oates, 1890), p. 86.

"The Voyages of Zheng He" is from Dun J. Li, ed. and trans., *The Civilization of China* (New York: Charles Scribner's Sons, 1975), pp. 279-281. Copyright © 1975 by Dun J. Li. Reprinted by permission of Charles Scribner's Sons.

"Gentleman Wang" is from Patricia Buckley Ebrey, ed. and trans., *Chinese Civilization and Society* (New York: Macmillan Publishing Co., Inc., 1981), pp. 159-160. Copyright © 1981 by The Free Press. Reprinted by permission.

"The Coming of the West" is from Dun J. Li, ed. and trans., *China in Transition: 1517-1911* (New York: Van Nostrand Reinhold Company, 1969), pp. 5-7. Copyright © 1969 by Litton Educational Publishing, Inc. Reprinted by permission.

"The Jesuits" is from Dun J. Li, ed. and trans., *China in Transition: 1517-1911* (New York: Van Nostrand Reinhold Company, 1969), pp. 14-15; 17. Copyright © 1969 by Litton Educational Publishing, Inc. Reprinted by permission.

"The Life of China" is from Louis J. Gallagher, trans., *The China That Was* (Milwaukee: The Bruce Publishing Company, 1942), pp. 18-19; 22; 25-26; 32-33. Copyright © 1942 by The Bruce Publishing Company. Reprinted by permission.

"The Grand Eunuch Wei" is from Dun J. Li, ed. and trans., *The Civilization of China* (New York: Charles Scribner's Sons, 1975), pp. 282-288. Copyright © 1975 by Dun J. Li. Reprinted by permission of Charles Scribner's Sons.

"A Plan for the Prince" is from William Theodore de Bary, ed., *Sources of Chinese Tradition* (New York: Columbia University Press, 1960), pp. 588-590. Copyright © 1960 by Columbia University Press. Reprinted by permission.

"The Slaughter on Mount Hiei" is from William Theodore de Bary, ed., *Sources of Japanese Tradition* (New York: Columbia University Press, 1958), pp. 314-316. Copyright © 1958 by Columbia University Press. Reprinted by permission.

"The Introduction of Firearms" is from William Theodore de Bary, ed., *Sources of Japanese Tradition* (New York: Columbia University Press, 1958), pp. 319-320. Copyright © 1958 by Columbia University Press. Reprinted by permission.

"The Sword Collection Edict" is from William Theodore de Bary, ed., *Sources of Japanese Tradition* (New York: Columbia University Press, 1958), p. 329. Copyright © 1958 by Columbia University Press. Reprinted by permission.

"Laws Governing Military Households" is from William Theodore de Bary, ed., *Sources of Japanese Tradition* (New York: Columbia University Press, 1958), pp. 336-338. Copyright © 1958 by Columbia University Press. Reprinted by permission.

"Closed Country Edict" is from David John Lu, *Sources in Japanese History*, Vol. 1 (New York: McGraw-Hill, 1974), pp. 207-208. Copyright © 1974 by McGraw-Hill Publishing Company. Reprinted by permission.